

Chapter 1

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. The Mystical Way
The Way that can be
described is not the
absolute Way;
the name that can be
given is not the
absolute name.
Nameless it is the
source of heaven and
earth;
named it is the
mother of all things.
Whoever is

Nature can never be completely described, for such a description of Nature would have to duplicate Nature. No name can fully express what it represents.

It is Nature itself, and not any part (or name or description) abstracted from Nature, which is the ultimate source of all that happens, all that comes and goes, begins and ends, is and is not. But to describe Nature as "the ultimate source of all" is still only a description, and such a description is not Nature itself.

Yet since, in order to speak of it, we must use words, we shall have to describe it as "the ultimate source of —

The Ineffable, about
which is spoken, is
not the eternal
Ineffable

A name for the
Unnameable, is but a
name

The Unnameable is
what makes
everything what it is

By naming things
you divide the
Indivisible

Only one who gives
up all his desires can

THE NATURE OF THE
TAO

The Tao-Path is not the
All-Tao.

The Name is not the Thing
named.

Unmanifested, it is the Secret
Father of

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Heaven

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and Earth

manifested, it is their Mother.

To understand this Mystery,
one must be fulfilling one's
will,

and if one is not thus free,
one will but gain a smattering
of it.

The Tao is one, and the Teh
but a phase thereof.

The Tao that can be defined is not the real Tao.

The name that can be named is not the real Name.

The unnamable [Tao] is the source of Heaven and Earth.

Naming is the mother of all particular things.

Free from

desireless, sees the
essence of life.

Whoever desires,
sees its
manifestations.

These two are the
same,

but what is produced
has names.

They both may be
called the cosmic
mystery:

from the cosmic to
the mystical

is the door to the
essence of all life.

all."

If Nature is inexpressible, he who desires to know Nature as it is in itself will not try to express it in words

Although the existence of Nature and a description of that existence are two different things, yet they are also the same.

For both are ways of existing. That is, a description of existence must have its own existence, which is different from the existence of that which it describes; and so again we have to recognize an existence which cannot be described.

experience the
Indivisible

One who still
cherishes desires,
will experience only
dissension

Both will see the
same reality, but
experience it
differently

One who goes from
the false reality into
the other,

Will pass through the
narrow gate and
receive the secret of
true life

desire, you
experience reality.

Trapped in desire,
you see only
appearances.

Reality and
appearance have
different names,
but they emerge from
the same source [i.e.,
the Tao].

This source is called
darkness, deep
darkness;
and yet it is the way
to all wisdom.

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Relativity and Not Interfering

When the people of the world all know beauty as beauty,

there arises the recognition of ugliness.

When they all know the good as good,

there arises the recognition of bad.

Therefore being and non-being produce each other;

difficult and easy complete each other;

long and short contrast each other;

high and low distinguish each other;

sound and voice harmonize with each

It is because we single out something and treat it as distinct from other things that we get the idea of its opposite. Beauty, for example, once distinguished, suggests its opposite, ugliness.

And goodness, when we think of it, is naturally opposed to badness.

In face, all distinctions naturally appear as opposites. And opposites get their meaning from each other and find their completion only through each other. The meaning of "is" and "is not" arise from our distinguishing between them.

Likewise "difficult and easy," "long and short," "high and low," "loud and soft," "before and after" - all derive their meanings from each other.

Therefore the intelligent man accepts what is as it is. In seeking to grasp what is, he does not devote himself to the making of distinctions which are then mistaken to be separate existences.

When people think `this ■ is beautiful, they must think `that ■ is ugly

When people say `this ■ is good, than they have to say `that ■ is evil

This is Inevitable

People create a false reality out of the real one

Hard and easy are relative

Long and short depend upon each other

High and low

THE ENERGY - SOURCE OF THE SELF

All men know that beauty and ugliness are correlatives, as are skill and clumsiness; one implies and suggests the other.

So also existence and non-existence pose the one the other;

so also is it with ease and difficulty, length and shortness; height and

lowness. Also Musick exists through harmony of opposites;

No beauty without ugliness.

No good without evil.

Being and non-being are two aspects of the same reality.

Difficult and easy, long and short, high and low, before and after:

With each pair, two sides of the same coin..

Therefore, the Tao-Master acts with

other;

beginning and end follow each other.

Therefore the wise manage affairs without interfering

and teach beyond the words.

All things rise, and they do not turn away from them.

They give them life, but do not take possession of them.

They act, but do not rely on their own ability.

They accomplish, but claim no credit.

Because they claim no credit,

their accomplishment remains with them.

In teaching, he teaches, not by describing and pointing out differences, but by example. Whatever exists, and he sees that nothing is gained by representing what fully exists by a description - another lesser, diluted kind of existence. If something exists which cannot be wholly revealed to him with his viewpoint, he does not demand of it that it be nothing but what it seems to him.

If some one else interprets him, he does not trust that interpretation as being equal to his own existence. If some part of him stands out as if a superior representative of his nature, he will not surrender the rest of his nature to it.

And in not surrendering the whole of his nature to any part of it, he keeps himself intact. This is how the intelligent man preserves his nature.

are determined by a position

Sound and voice need one another

Before and beyond assume a point of view

That's why a wise man acts without intentions

And won't decide for others what to do

He'll let anything happen as it happens

He won't consider what he does as his own merit

And only therein is he praiseworthy

By the use of this method, the sage can fulfil his will without action,

and utter his word without speech.

All things arise without diffidence; they grow, and none interferes; they

change according to their natural order, without lust of result. The

work is accomplished; yet continueth in its orbit, without goal. This

work is done unconsciously; this is why its energy is indefatigable.

non-ado [wu-wei]

and teaches without speaking.

Things come and go. He lets them come and go.

He creates, but he does not own.

He achieves, but he takes no credit.

He completes his work and then forgets about it.

Practice non-ado, and your accomplishments endure.

. Simplicity Do not exalt the worthy, so that people will not compete. Do not value rare treasure, so that people will not steal. Do not display objects of desire, so that people's hearts will not be disturbed. Therefore the wise lead	If no distinctions of superiority and inferiority prevail among officers, they will devote themselves to their tasks rather than to rivalries with one another. If no special value is placed upon rare things, one will have no incentive for stealing them. If nothing appears to arouse envy, one will remain satisfied with things as they are Since this is so, the wise administrator does not lead people to set their hearts upon what they cannot have, but satisfies their inner needs.	When you praise people for their achievements, people will compete When you call things valuable, people will steal When people flaunt desirable things, it will make other people restless Therefore the sage sets himself to the task of emptying their heads To	QUIETING FOLK To reward merit is to stir up emulation; to prize rarities is to encourage robbery; to display desirable things is to excite the disorder of covetousness. Therefore, the sage governeth men by keeping their minds and their bodies at rest, contenting the one by emptiness, the other by fullness. He satisfieth their desires,	Glorify the superior, hatch jealousy and competition. Value possessions, provoke stealing. Stimulate desire, enflame the passions. Therefore, the Tao–Master would rule by emptying minds and filling bellies, by weakening desire
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by keeping their hearts pure, their bellies full, their ambitions weak, and their bones strong, so that the people may be purified of their thoughts and desires; and the cunning ones will not interfere. By acting without interfering, all may live in peace.	He does not promote ambition to improve their status, but supports their self-sufficiency. He does not complicate their lives with knowledge of multifarious details or with an urge to attend to this, that and the other. By keeping people contented, he prevents those who mistakenly believe that ambition is better than contentment from leading the contented astray. By being calm and contented himself, he sets an example for his people.	make sure they're not hungry, discourage their ambitions and strengthen their bodies So people will be without anxiety and without the desire for knowledge And the scientists will be played off the field When people won't labour anymore All will live in peace	thus fulfilling their wills, and making them frictionless; and he maketh them strong in body, to a similar end. He delivereth them from the restlessness of knowledge and the cravings of discontent. As to those who have knowledge already, he teacheth them the way of non-action. This being assured, there is no disorder in the world.	and strengthening bodies. He would lead the people away from knowing and wanting and would try to prevent those with knowledge from interfering. Practice non–ado, and everything will fall into place.
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The Infinite Way

The Way is infinite;
its use is never
exhausted.

It is bottomless, like
the fountainhead of
all things.

It smoothes its
roughness; it unties

Nature contains
nothing but natures;
and these natures are
nothing over and
above Nature.

In Nature, all natures
originate,
all conflicts are
settled, all
differences are
united, all
disturbances are
quieted.

That which maintains
the Creation

Is like an empty
barrel that's
inexhaustible

It is like a fathomless
emptiness, filling the
whole Creation

Its sharpness brings
about curves

Its angles dissolve

It dims its

THE SPRING
WITHOUT
SOURCE

The Tao resembleth
the emptiness of
Space; to employ it,
we must avoid
creating ganglia. Oh
Tao, how vast art
Thou, the Abyss of
Abysses, thou

Holy and Secret
Father of all
Fatherhoods of
Things!

Let us make our

The Tao is empty:
used but never used
up.

It is the bottomless
source of all things.

It blunts sharp edges,
unties knots, softens

its tangles.

It softens its light; it
calms its turmoil.

Deep and still, ever
present.

I do not know its
source.

It seems to have
existed before the
Lord.

Yet no matter how
many natures come
into being, they can
never exhaust
Nature.

To look for an
external source of
Nature is foolish, for
Nature is the source
of all else.

light

It restrains its touch

How pure and calm it
stays, like deep
waters

I don't know its
origin

It seems like it is
even older than that
by which it is
brought forth

sharpness blunt; let
us loosen our
complexes; let us
tone down our
brightness to the
general obscurity. Oh
Tao, how still art
thou, how pure,
continuous One
beyond Heaven!

This Tao hath no
Father; it is beyond
all other conceptions,
higher than
the highest.

glare, clears dust.

It is hidden, but
always present.

I don't know its
mother.

It is older than the
gods [if there are any
gods].

. Emptiness and the Center Nature is not humane. It treats all things like sacrificial objects. The wise are not humane. They regard people like sacrificial objects. How the universe	Opposites are not sympathetic to each other. Each one of the many kinds of opposites acts as if it could get along without its other. But Nature treats opposites impartially, dealing with each of every pair of opposites with the same indifference. And the intelligent man will regard opposites in the same manner. No matter how deeply natures are torn by opposition, Nature itself remains unchanged.	The Creation does not pretend to be friendly It treats all things impartially One who is wise doesn't act friendly All people are equal to him The Universe is like bellows	THE FORMULA OF THE VACUUM Heaven and earth proceed without motive, but casually in their order of nature, dealing with all things carelessly, like used talismans. So also the sages deal with their people, not exercising benevolence, but allowing the nature	The Tao is impartial; it sees all things as straw [fake] dogs. The Tao—Master is also impartial; he regards people as straw dogs. The Tao
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is like a bellows! While empty, it is never exhausted. The more it is worked, the more it produces. Much talk brings exhaustion. It is better to keep to the center.	In conflicts between opposites, the more one attacks his seeming opponent (upon which he really depends for his completion), the more he defeats himself (and thereby demonstrates that only Nature, and not any opposite abstracted from existence, is self-sufficient). So, likewise, no matter how much debaters argue, their argument proves nothing. Things are what they are, regardless of how much we disagree about them.	Although empty, it fills continuously The harder it works, the more it brings forth The more you talk about it, the wearier you get Therefore, you'd better stick to what really matters	of all to move without friction. The Space between heaven and earth is their breathing apparatus: Exhalation is not exhaustion, but the complement of Inhalation, and this equally of that. Speech exhausteth; guard thyself, therefore, maintaining the perfect freedom of thy nature.	is like a bellows: it is empty yet infinitely available. It is always producing. Speak of it, fail to grasp it. Hold on to the center.
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. The Mystical Female The spirit of the valley never dies. It is called the mystical female. The door of the mystical	The tendency towards opposition is ever-present. Opposition is the source of all growth. And the principle of opposition is the source of all	The spirit of depth never dies People sometimes call it the Great Mother The gate through which she breathes	THE PERFECTING OF FORM The Teh is the immortal enemy of the Tao, its feminine aspect. Heaven and Earth issued from	The valley spirit, the Great Mother: Her doorway is the channel from
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female is the root of heaven and earth. It seems to be continuously within us. Use it, and it will never fail.	opposites. The principle of opposition is inherent in Nature, so oppositeness will continue forever, no matter how many opposites may come and go.	Is the foundation of Creation It appears to be everlasting When you rely on that, life will be effortless	her Gate; this Gate is the Root of their World- Sycamore. Its operation is of pure Joy and Love, and faileth never.	which Heaven and Earth came forth. She is always present and inexhaustible.
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Enduring
Heaven is eternal,
and the earth is very
old.
They can be eternal
and long lasting,
because they do not
exist for themselves,
and for this reason
can long endure.
Therefore

The principle of
initiation persists;
and the principle of
completion
continues.
Why do such
opposing principles
persist? Because they
inhere in Nature,
rather than stand by
themselves. That is
why opposites
endure.
The intelligent man,
when an

The Universe is
everlasting
The reason why it is
everlasting
Is because it doesn't
exist for itself
Therefore it can last
Therefore a wise man
behaves as the least

THE
CONCEALMENT
OF THE LIGHT
Heaven and Earth are
mighty in
continuance, because
their work is
delivered from the
lust of result.
Thus also the sage,
seeking not any goal,
attaineth all things;

Heaven and Earth are
everlasting.
Since they were
never born, they will
never die.
They do not exist for
themselves and thus
go on forever.

the wise put
themselves last,
but find themselves
foremost.
They are indifferent
to themselves,
and yet they always
remain.
Is it not because they
do not live for
themselves
that they find
themselves fulfilled?

issue arises, stands
off and observes both
contentions.
Since he does not
take sides, he never
loses a battle.
By not favouring one
side more than the
other, he is able to
appreciate the virtues
of both sides.

And because he is
least, he is the
greatest
He is detached and
therefore he is safe
Couldn't it be
possible that he is
perfect,
Just because he is
disinterested?

he doth
not interfere in the
affairs of his body,
and so that body
acteth without
friction. It is because
he meddleth not with
personal aims that
these
come to pass with
simplicity.

The Tao—Master
stays behind and is
thus ahead.
He is detached and is
thus one with all
things.
He is selfless and is
thus fulfilled.

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The Best Are Like Water

The best are like water.

Water benefits all things and does not compete with them.

It flows to the lowest level.

In this it comes near to the Way.

In their dwellings, they love the earth.

In their hearts,

The best way to conduct oneself may be observed in the behaviour of water. Water is useful to every living thing, yet it does not demand pay in return for its services; it does not even require that it be recognized, esteemed, or appreciated for its benefits. This illustrates how intelligent behaviour so closely approximates the behaviour of Nature itself.

If experience teaches that houses should

A perfect human being is like the water

That benefits all things and competes with nothing

It stays in places which others despise

But in this way it follows its origin

In his heart the wise cherishes simplicity

In contact with

THE NATURE OF PEACE

Admire thou the High Way of Water! Is not Water the soul of the life of things, whereby they change? Yet it seeketh its level, and abideth

content in obscurity. So also it resembleth the Tao, in this Way thereof!

The virtue of a house is to be well-placed; of the mind,

It is good to be like water.

It nourishes without effort.

It flows without contention into low places that people scorn.

Thus, it is like the Tao.

In dwelling, live close to the land.

they love what is profound.

In their friendship, they love humanity.

In their words, they love sincerity.

In government, they love peace.

In business, they love ability.

In their actions, they love timeliness.

It is because they do not compete that there is no resentment.

be built close to the ground, That friendship should be based on sympathy and good will,

That good government employs peaceful means of regulation, That business is more successful if it employs efficient methods, That wise behaviour adapts itself appropriately to the particular circumstances, All this is because these are the easiest ways.

If one proceeds naturally, without ambition or envy, everything works out for the best.

others he is amiable

In his words he is reliable

In his leading he is peaceful

In what he does he is competent

He does everything at the moment it needs to be done

He won't fight

And therefore he is impeccable

to be at ease in

silence as of Space; of societies, to be well-disposed; of governments,

to maintain quietude; of work, to be skillfully performed; and of all

motion, to be made at the right time.

Also it is the virtue of a man to abide in his place without discontent; thus offendeth he no man.

In thinking, go deep.

In relating to others, be gentle.

In governing, seek good order and justice.

In acting, be skillful.

In working, do all things at the right time.

No contention, no strife.

Moderation
Stretch a bow to the very full,
and you will wish you had stopped in time.
Temper a sword-edge to its very sharpest,
and the edge will not last long.
When gold and jade fill

Going to extremes is never best.
For if you make a blade too sharp, it will become dull too quickly
And if you hoard all the wealth, you are bound to be attacked.
If you become proud

It is better to carry an empty barrel than a full one
Sharpen a knife until it is razor-sharp and it won't last long
When a house is filled with valuables, it

THE WAY OF RETICENCE
Fill not a vessel, lest it spill in carrying.
Meddle not with a sharpened point by feeling it constantly, or it will soon become blunted.
Gold and jade endanger the house of their possessor.

Fill your bowl all the way: it overflows.
Keep sharpening your sword: it gets dull.
Pile up gold and jade:

your hall,
you will not be able to keep them safe.
To be proud with honor and wealth is to cause one's own downfall.
Withdraw as soon as your work is done.
Such is heaven's way.

and arrogant regarding your good fortune, you will naturally beget enemies who jealously despise you.
The way to success is this: having achieved your goal, be satisfied not to go further. For this is the way Nature operates.

is impossible to guard
When wealth and ambition make one arrogant, it will lead to a fall
When fame and success menace you, pull back
That's the only road to true bliss

Wealth and honors lead to arrogance and envy, and bring ruin. Is thy way famous and thy name becoming distinguished? Withdraw, thy work once done, into obscurity; this is the way of Heaven.

it cannot be protected.
Increase your wealth, status, and power: you suffer ruin.
Do your work, then withdraw: that's the Way!

Mystical Power

Can you embrace the One with your soul, and never depart from the Way?

Can you concentrate your vital force to achieve the gentleness of a new-born baby?

Can you cleanse and purify your mystic vision until it is clear?

Can you love the people and govern the state without

If you would retain a wholesome personality, must you not restrain your lower interests from dominating over your higher interests?

If you wish to live healthily, should you not breathe naturally, like a child, and not hold your breath until your vitality is nearly exhausted?

If you desire to realize the potentialities of your indescribable original nature, how can you insist that some selected aspect of your personality is really superior to that original nature?

If you are required to govern others, ought you not be able to guide them by example, rather than by forcing your will upon them?

If Nature's way is a joint process of initiation and

Can you empty your head and lastingly lose yourself in Creation?

Can you live up to your nature and become like a child?

Can you purify the doors of perception and see clearly again?

Can you love your fellow man and serve mankind disinterestedly?

Can you go in and out of the narrow gate without any effort?

THINGS ATTAINABLE

When soul and body are in the bond of love, they can be kept together.

By concentration on the breath it is brought to perfect elasticity, and one becomes as a babe. By purifying oneself from Samadhi one becomes whole

In his dealing with individuals and with society, let him move without lust of result.

Can you keep body and soul together and find your wholeness in the One?

Can you make your breathing as soft as a newborn child's?

Can you cleanse your inner vision until you see with perfect clarity?

Can you love the people and govern the

interfering?

Can you play the role of the female in opening and closing the doors of heaven?

Can you understand all and penetrate all without using the mind?

To give birth and to nourish, to give birth without taking possession, to act without obligation, to lead without dominating--- this is mystical power.

completion, sowing and reaping, producing and consuming, can you rightly demand that you deserve always to play the role of the consumer?

If you desire to know the nature of the various kinds of things, must you meddle with them, experiment with them, try to change them, in order to find out?

Nature procreates all things and then devotes itself to caring for them, Just as parents give birth to children without keeping them as slaves. It willingly gives life, without first asking whether the creatures will repay for its services. It provides a pattern to follow, without requiring anyone to follow it. This is the secret of intelligent activity.

Can you be in the world without being possessed by it?

Can you realize that you can't know anything and therefore understand everything?

Nature brings forth everything and feeds everything

She brings forth but possesses nothing

She does everything disinterestedly and asks for nothing

She leads but demands nothing

That is what people call the incomprehensibility of Nature

In the management of his breath, let him be like the mother-bird. Let his intelligence comprehend every quarter; but let his knowledge cease.

Here is the Mystery of Virtue. It createth all and nourisheth all; yet it doth not adhere to them; it operateth all, but knoweth not of it, nor proclaimeth it; it directeth all, but without conscious control.

country without ado?

Can you, like a woman, open and close the gates of Heaven?

Can you understand all things and take no action?

Giving birth and nourishing, having but not owning, acting without seeking praise, leading but not dominating: this is the highest virtue [Te].

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Use What Does Not Exist
Thirty spokes are united around the hub of a wheel, but the usefulness of the wheel depends on the space where nothing exists. Clay is molded into a vessel, but the usefulness of the vessel depends

Every positive involves its negative or opposing factor; for example: In order to turn a wheel, although thirty spokes must revolve, the axle must remain motionless; so both the moving and the non-moving are needed to produce revolution.
In order to mold a vase, although one must use clay, he must also provide a hollow space of empty

Thirty spokes unite within the nave
But the wheel is only useful because of the cavity inside the nave
Clay is kneaded into vases
But the utility is determined by the cavity
When building a

THE VALUE OF THE UNEXPRESSED
The thirty spokes join in their nave, that is one; yet the wheel dependeth for use upon the hollow place for the axle.

Thirty spokes are joined in the hub of the wheel, but it is the center hole, where it is empty, that makes the wheel useful.
We make a clay pot, but it is the emptiness inside that makes the

on the space where nothing exists.
Doors and windows are cut out of the walls of a house, and the usefulness of the house depends on the space where nothing exists. Therefore take advantage of what exists, and use what does not exist.

clay; so both clay and the absence of clay are required to produce a vessel.
In order to build a house, although we must establish solid walls, we must also provide doors and windows; so both the impenetrable and penetrable are essential to a useful building.
Therefore, we profit equally by the positive and negative ingredients in each situation.

house they leave blank spots in the walls for doors and windows
But the utility of the house depends on the cavity inside
Therefore, that which exists is useful
But the cavity makes it possible

Clay is shapen to make vessels; but the contained space is what is useful. Matter is therefore of use only to mark the limits of the space which is the thing of real value.

pot useful.
We cut windows and doors to make a room, but it is the inner emptiness that makes the room useful.
We seek to take advantage of what is, but we also find much use for what is not.

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Satisfy the Inner Self
The five colors blind the eyes;
the five musical tones deafen the ears;
the five flavors dull the taste.
Racing and hunting madden

Interest in the varieties of colour diverts the eye from regarding the thing which is coloured. Attention to the differences between sounds distracts the ear from consideration for the source of the sounds.

All those artificial colours blind people's eyes
All that man-made music deafens people's ears
All those various flavours dull our taste
Horse races and hunting drive people crazy
The desire for scarce goods

THE WITHDRAWAL FROM THE EXTERNAL
The five colors film over Sight; The five sounds make Hearing dull; The five flavours conceal Taste; occupation with motion and action bedevil Mind; even so the esteem of

The five colors can make us blind.
The five sounds can make us deaf.
The five flavors can deaden our taste.
Racing, chasing, and hunting can drive us

the mind.
Precious goods keep their owners on guard.
Therefore the wise satisfy the inner self rather than external senses.
They accept the one and reject the other.

Desire for enjoyment of the various flavours misdirects the appetite from seeking foods which are truly nourishing.
Excessive devotion to chasing about and pursuing things agitates the mind with insane excitement. Greed for riches ensnares one's efforts to pursue his healthier motives.
The intelligent man is concerned about his genuine needs and avoids being confused by dazzling appearances. He wisely distinguishes one from the other.

Hinders people from going on the straight and simple path
Therefore the wise finds his satisfaction
In feeding himself and then he won't exhaust his eyes
Therefore he does this and leaves that

rare things begetteth covetousness and disorder.
The wise man seeketh therefore to content the actual needs of the people; not to excite them by the sight of luxuries. He banneth these, and concentrateth on those.

mad.
The pursuit of treasure knocks us off the path.
Therefore, the Tao–Master follows his inner vision rather than his outer vision.
He chooses this but not that.

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Selflessness

Good fortune and misfortune cause apprehension.

Regard great trouble as you regard your self.

What is meant by

"Good fortune and misfortune cause apprehension?"

Those with good fortune are apprehensive of their gain.

Those with misfortune are apprehensive of their loss.

What is meant by

Pride and shame cause us much fearful anxiety. But our inner peace and distress should be our primary concerns.

Why do pride and shame cause us so much fearful anxiety? Because: Pride attaches undue importance to the superiority of one's status in the eyes of others; And shame is fear of humiliation at one's inferior status in the estimation of others. When one sets his heart on being highly esteemed, and achieves such rating, then he is automatically involved in fear of losing his status. Then protection of his status appears to be his most important need. And humiliation seems the worst of all evils.

Watch out for gratitude and criticism

Honour and misfortune are as disastrous as having character

What does that say?

Watch out for gratitude and criticism?

Watch out for gratitude, because it originates from submission

Watch out for criticism, because it comes from superior power

Therefore, watch out for gratitude and criticism

THE CONTEMPT FOR CIRCUMSTANCE

Favor and disgrace are equally to be shunned; honour and calamity to be

alike regarded as adhering to the personality.

What is this which is written concerning favour and disgrace? Disgrace

is the fall from favour. He then that hath favour hath fear, and its

loss begetteth fear yet greater of a further fall.

Being in favor or being in disgrace: either way, trouble.

It is all within the Self.

What does this mean?

Being in favor, we fear falling out of favor.

Being out of favor, we fear remaining there.

This fear

great trouble as you regard your self?"

Great trouble comes from being selfish.

Being selfless, what trouble is there?

Therefore those who value the world as themselves

may be entrusted to govern the world.

Those who love the world as themselves

may be entrusted to care for the world.

This is the reason why pride and shames cause us so much fearful anxiety.

Why should our inner peace and distress be our primary concerns? Because: The inner self is our true self; so in order to realize our true self, we must be willing to live without being dependent upon the opinions of others. When we are completely self-sufficient, then we can have no fear of disesteem.

He who wisely devotes himself to being self-sufficient, and therefore does not depend for his happiness upon external ratings by others, is the one best able to set an example for, and to teach and govern, others.

does it mean that honour and misfortune are as bad as having character?

Disasters come over us because we've got something to lose

If we had nothing to lose, which disasters could still strike us?

Therefore: to him who considers himself just as worthy as the world,

Mankind can entrust the world

And to him who loves himself and the world just as unconditionally,

Mankind can entrust the care for the world

What is this which is written concerning honour and calamity? It is this attachment to the

body which maketh calamity possible; for were one bodiless, what evil

could befall him?

Therefore let him that regardeth himself rightly administer also a

kingdom; and let him govern it who loveth it as another man loveth

himself.

is within the Self.

No Self, no fear.

Do you value the world as you value yourself?

You may be trusted to rule.

Do you love the world as you love yourself?

The world may be entrusted to your care.

. The Formless Way We look at it, and do not see it; it is invisible. We listen to it, and do not hear it; it is inaudible. We touch it, and do not feel it; it is intangible. These three elude our inquiries, and hence merge into one. Not by its rising, is it bright, nor by its sinking, is it dark. Infinite	Since what is ultimate in Nature cannot be seen with one's eyes, it is spoken of as invisible. Since it cannot be heard with one's ears, it is called inaudible. Since it cannot be grasped in one's hands, it is thought of as intangible But not even all these three together can adequately describe it. Nature did not originate in beginnings, and will not reach its goal in endings. Rather it acts unceasingly, without either absolute beginnings or final endings.	We look at it but we do not see it and we call it the invisible We listen to it but don't hear it and we call it the inaudible We grope at it but never touch it and we call it the untouchable The invisible, the inaudible and the untouchable come together in one There is no light when it rises There is no darkness when it descends Continuously, constantly, but it cannot be put into —	THE SHEWING-FORTH OF THE MYSTERY We look at it, and see it not; though it is Omnipresent; and we name it the Root-Balance. We listen for it, and hear it not, though it is Omniscient; and we name it the Silence. We feel for it, and touch it not, though it is Omnipotent; and we name it the Concealed. These three Virtues hath it, yet we cannot describe it as consisting of them; but, mingling them aright, we apprehend the One.	Look, but you can't see it. Listen, but you can't hear it. Reach out, but you can't touch it. Invisible, inaudible, intangible. Elusive. The One. When it rises, no light. When it sets,
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and eternal, it cannot be defined. It returns to nothingness. This is the form of the formless, being in non-being. It is nebulous and elusive. Meet it, and you do not see its beginning. Follow it, and you do not see its end. Stay with the ancient Way in order to master what is present. Knowing the primeval beginning is the essence of the Way.	understanding. Nature is the formless source of all forms, and yet it remains unaffected by its forms. Thus it appears to us as if mysterious. No matter how closely we scrutinize its coming toward us, we cannot discover a beginning. No matter how long we pursue it, we never find its end. One must comprehend the way in which the original Nature itself operates, if he wishes to control present conditions. That is, he should study the ultimate source itself. This is the way to understand how Nature behaves.	words And it returns to nothing This is what they call the form of the formless, the image of the invisible People call it indefinite and impalpable You won't see it from the front You won't see it from behind One who lives after their original conscience, lives in the present And understands everything that has ever been	It moveth all continuously, without Expression, returning into Naught. It is the Form of That which is beyond Form; it is the Image of the Invisible; it is Change, and Without Limit. We confront it, and see not its Face; we pursue it, and its Back is hidden from us. Ah! but apply the Tao as in old Time to the work of the present; know it as it was known in the Beginning; follow fervently the Thread of the Tao.	no darkness. It calls all things back into nothingness [No-Thing-Ness]. Formless form, imageless image. No front, no back. Live in the Tao of old, master the present. Know the Source: The essence of Tao.
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The Wise

The wise have ancient mystic wisdom and profound understanding, too deep to comprehend.

Because they can not be comprehended,

they can only be described by analogy:

cautious, like crossing a stream in winter;

alert, like one aware of danger on all sides;

courteous, like a visiting guest;

In primitive times, intelligent men had an intuitively penetrating grasp of reality which could not be stated in words.

Since their instinctive beliefs have not been recorded for us, we can only infer them from old sayings which have come down to us. Regarding caution when crossing a stream in winter: the more nervous you are, the more likely you are to slip and fall: Regarding suspicion of enemies; the more you fear others, the more the will be afraid of you: Regarding courtesy as a guest: the longer you stay, the more you become indebted to your host.

Regarding melting ice: the more you do to prevent it from melting, the quicker it melts. Regarding making furniture: the more you carve the wood, the weaker it gets.

The wise of old were profound and acute

People thought of them as unfathomable

Because they where unfathomable, I'll try to sketch their way of living:

They seemed cautious, like people who cross a wintry river

They seemed irresolute, as if danger was threatening everywhere

They seemed dignified, as if they where guests

THE APPEARANCE OF THE TRUE NATURE

The adepts of past ages were subtle and keen to apprehend this Mystery,

and their profundity was obscurity unto men. Since then they were not

known, let me declare their nature.

To all seeming, they were fearful as men that cross a torrent in winter

flood; they were hesitating like a man in apprehension of them that are

about him; they were full of awe like a guest in a great house; they were

The Tao—Masters of old had profound wisdom and deep understanding.

They were unfathomable.

We cannot comprehend them; all we can do is describe them:

Cautious, like someone crossing an icy stream;

Alert, like someone sensing danger;

Courteous, like a houseguest;

Yielding, like melting ice;

Undefined, like a piece of uncarved

wood;

open and receptive, like a valley;

freely mixing, like muddy water.

Who can make sense of a muddy world?

Let it be still, and it becomes clear.

Who can remain calm,

and through activity come back to life?

Those who embrace this Way do not over-extend themselves.

Because they do not over-extend themselves,

Regarding digging ditches: the steeper you slope their sides, the sooner they will wash down. Regarding muddy water: The more you try to stir the dirt out of it, the murkier it gets.

What, then, should we do in order to clear the muddy water? Leave it alone and the dirt will settle out by itself. What, then, must we do in order to achieve contentment? Let each thing act according to its own nature, and it will eventually come to rest in its own way.

Those who fully comprehend the true nature of existence do not try to push things to excess. And because they do not try to push things to excess, they are able to satisfy their needs repeatedly without exhausting themselves.

seemed empty, like a valley

They seemed opaque, like muddy water

How can one make muddy water clear?

Stagnation will settle the mud down and the water will become clear

Let everything happen as it happens and you will come to rest

The head of the wise is empty, he does not search for anything and expects nothing

He is empty, everlasting, youthful and not caught in time

ice in thaw; they were unassuming like unworked

wood; they were empty as a valley; and dull as the waters of a marsh.

Who can clear muddy water? Stillness will accomplish this. Who can

obtain rest? Let motion continue equably, and it will itself be peace.

The adepts of the Tao, conserving its way, seek not to be actively self-

conscious. By their emptiness of Self they have no need to show

their youth and perfection; to appear old and imperfect is their

wood;

Open, like a valley;

Murky, like muddy water.

We must wait for the water to settle; then it will be clear.

Can you keep still until what is needed becomes clear?

Those who follow the Tao are not full of themselves.

They are like durable garments that need no renewal.

. Know the Eternal Empty yourself of everything. Maintain a steady serenity. All things take shape and become active, but I see them return to their source, like vegetation that grows and flourishes, but returns to the root from which it springs. Returning to the source is serenity; it is to realize one's destiny. To realize one's destiny is to know the eternal. To know the eternal is to be enlightened. Not to know the	In order to arrive at complete contentment, restrain your ambitions. For everything which comes into being eventually returns again to the source from which it came. Each thing which grows and develops to the fullness of its own nature completes its course by declining again in a manner inherently determined by its own nature. Completing its life is as inevitable as that each thing shall have its own goal. Each thing having its own goal is necessary to the nature of things. He who knows that this is the ultimate nature of things is intelligent; he who does not is not.	One who has an empty head is satisfied, One who is satisfied has an empty head All creatures exert and come to rest All plants grow to maturity and come to rest That final rest is what's called being done; completion Returning to nature is what's called eternal life Living in the present is called being enlightened One who is	THE WITHDRAWAL TO THE ROOT Emptiness must be perfect, and Silence made absolute with tireless strength. All things pass through the period of action; then they return to repose. They grow, bud, blossom and fruit; then they return to the root. This return to the root is this state which we name Silence; and this Silence is Witness of their Fulfilment. This cycle is the universal law. To know it is the part of intelligence;	Empty yourself. Be calm. The ten thousand things come and go. Just watch them. All things return to the Source, where there is stillness. To return to the Source is to recover what is permanent. Knowing what is permanent: enlightenment. Not knowing what is permanent: disaster. Knowing
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eternal is to act blindly and court disaster. Whoever knows the eternal is open to everything. Whoever is open to everything is impartial. To be impartial is to be universal. To be universal is to be in accord with heaven. To be in accord with heaven is to be in accord with the Way. To be in accord with the Way is to be eternal and to live free from harm even though the body dies.	Being intelligent, he knows that each has a nature which is able to take care of itself. Knowing this, he is willing that each thing follow its own course. Being willing to let each thing follow its own course, he is gracious. Being gracious, he is like the source which graciously gives life to all. Being like the gracious source of all, he embodies Nature's way within his own being. And in thus embodying Nature's way within himself, he embodies its perpetually recurrent principles within himself. And so, regardless of what happens to his body, there is something about him which goes on forever.	not enlightened lives in confusion and misery One who lives according to his nature understands everything and is forbearing One who is forbearing is righteous One who is righteous is royal One who is royal is divine One who is divine knows oneself One who knows oneself has eternal life	To know it bringeth understanding and peace; and these lead to the identification of the Self with the Not-Self. This identification maketh man a king; and this kingliness groweth unto godhood. That godhood beareth fruit in the mastery of the Tao. Then the man, the Tao permeating him, endureth; and his bodily principles are in harmony, proof against decay, until the hour of his Change.	what is permanent opens the mind. Open mind, open heart. Open heart, magnanimity. Magnanimity, a virtue of queens and kings. A true queen or king lives in accord with Nature. To live in accord with Nature is to find the Tao. Following the Tao makes death harmless.
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Leaders
The best leaders the people barely know.
The next best they love and praise.
The next they fear.
And the next they hate.
Those who

The most intelligent leaders bring about results without making those controlled realize that they are being influenced. The less intelligent seek to motivate others by appeals to loyalty, honour, self-interest, and flattery. Those still less intelligent employ fear by making their followers think they will not receive their rewards. The worst try to force others to improve by condemning their conduct.
But since, if

Of the wise of old, people only knew that they existed
Later on they loved them and admired them
Thereafter they got scared of them
And finally the wise were seen as

THE PURITY OF THE CURRENT
In the Age of Gold, the people were not conscious of their rulers; in the Age of Silver, they loved them, with songs; in the Age of Brass, they feared them; in the Age of Iron, they despised them. As the rulers lost confidence, so

The best ruler: hardly known to exist.
Next best: known and loved.
Next best: feared.
The worst: despised.
No trust given,

lack trust will not be trusted.
Then they resort to promises.
But when they accomplish their task and complete their work,
the people say, "We did it ourselves."

leaders do not trust their followers then their followers will not trust the leaders, The intelligent leader will be careful not to speak as if he doubted or distrusted his follower's ability to do the job suitably.
When the work is done, and as he wanted it done, he will be happy if the followers say: "This is just the way we wanted it."

despicable
One who can't trust oneself, can't trust another
How cautious were the first with their words
They proceeded so cautiously that when they were done
The people thought they did it themselves

also did the people lose confidence in them.
How hesitating did they seem, the Lords of the Age of Gold, speaking with deliberation, aware of the weight of their word! Thus they accomplished all things with success; and the people deemed their well-being to be the natural course of events.

no trust received.
The best ruler rules without fanfare.
When his work is successful, the people say,
"Fantastic! We've done it!"

. When the Way is Forgotten When the great Way is forgotten, the doctrines of humanity and morality arise. When knowledge and cleverness appear, there emerges great hypocrisy.	When people try to improve upon, and thus deviate from, the way Nature itself naturally functions, they develop artificial codes of right and wrong. When knowledge becomes highly abstract, men are deceived by mistaking abstractions	When people deviate from their nature Friendliness and righteousness became merits to be earned Knowledge and cleverness came into being and lying started to rule	THE DECAY OF MANNERS When men abandoned the Way of the Tao, benevolence and justice became necessary. Then also was need of wisdom and cunning, and all fell into illusion.	When the Tao is not followed, kindness and morality appear. When intelligence and learning are exalted, pretentiousness emerges. When there is no peace and order
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When family relationships are not in harmony, filial piety and parental love are advocated. When a country falls into chaos and disorder, there is praise of loyal patriots.	for realities. When instinctive family sympathies are replaced by rules for proper conduct then parents become "responsible" and children become "dutiful". When corruption replaces genuine benevolence in government, then loyalty oaths are demanded of officials.	Relatives came into conflict with each other and loving each other became a duty Cause when mankind and families get confused Allegiance becomes an order	When harmony ceased to prevail in the six spheres it was needful to govern them by manifesting Sons. When the kingdoms and races became confused, loyal ministers had to appear.	in the family, then we get all kinds of talk about "family values." When the country is badly governed and in chaos, we then glorify patriotism.
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What People Need

Abandon religion and discard cleverness, and people will benefit a hundredfold.

Abandon humanity and discard morality, and people will rediscover love and duty.

Abandon skill and discard profit,

Therefore - If we ignore intricate learning and knowledge of petty distinctions, we shall be many times better off.

If we neglect to insist upon the formal proprieties of etiquette, our intuitive sympathies will return.

If we

Dispose yourself of worldly knowledge and cleverness

And it will only be good for mankind

Stop pretending to be nice and fair, but be it

Then people will love each other unconditionally

Dispose yourself of the work of your

RETURNING TO THE PURITY OF THE CURRENT

If we forgot our statesmanship and our wisdom, it would be an hundred times better for the people. If we forgot our benevolence and our justice, they would become again like sons, folk of good will. If we

Discard learning and knowledge,

and the people will be a hundred times happier.

Banish kindness and morality,

and the people will rediscover love and duty.

Forget about industry and

and there will be no thieves or robbers.

These three things relate to externals and are inadequate.

People need what they can depend on: reveal simplicity; embrace the natural; control selfishness; reduce desires.

abolish opportunities for profiteering "within the law," incentive for political corruption will disappear.

If the foregoing three principles are unclear, then at least the following are understandable:

Simply be yourself. Act naturally. Refrain from self-assertiveness. Avoid covetousness.

hands and stop serving your self-interest

And there will be no thieves or robbers anymore

But these three things won't be enough

What it's really about is turning back to simplicity

Giving up your selfishness and not wishing for anything

forget our machines and our business, there would be no knavery.

These new methods despised the olden Way, inventing fine names to disguise their baneness. But simplicity in the doing of the will of every man would put an end to vain ambitions and desires.

profit,

and there won't be any thieves.

When these three things are done, more will be required:

Look at plain silk; hold uncarved wood; let self dwindle; let desire fade.

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Drawing Sustenance

Abandon memorizing, and vexations end.

How much difference is there between yes and no?

How much difference is there between good and evil?

Is what people fear really to be feared?

How very remote the actual occurrence!

The people of the world make merry

as though at a holiday feast or a spring carnival.

I alone am inactive and desireless,

like a new-born baby who cannot yet smile,

unattached, as though homeless.

The people of the world possess more than

If we stop fussing about grammatical trivialities, we will get along much better. The difference between "Yes" and "ya" is insignificant as compared with a genuine distinction like "Good" and "Bad".

Yet some people are as fearful of making a grammatical mistake as of committing a vital error. How stupid to waste our lives in infinite details!

While others enjoy devoting themselves to ceremonious holiday celebrations, such as the spring festivals, I stay at home as unperturbed as a helpless babe.

When you unlearn what you have learned, you will be free from worries

We've learned that there is but little difference between yes and no, but

That there is a big difference between good and evil

That we have to be scared of what others are scared of

What an endless pack of bullshit

Everybody is restless and excited like they are watching a soccer game

Only I am at rest and unwound and I don't have to do those things and like a child, I want nothing

I'm not attached

THE WITHDRAWAL FROM THE COMMON WAY

To forget learning is to end trouble. The smallest difference in words,

such as 'yes' and 'yea', can make endless controversy for the

scholar. Fearful indeed is death, since all men fear it; but the abyss of

questionings, shoreless and bottomless, is worse!

Consider the profane man, how he preeneth, as if at feast, or gazing upon

Spring from a tower! But as for me, I am as one who yawneth, without any

trace of desire. I am like a babe before its first smile. I appear sad

and forlorn, like a man homeless.

No more learning, no more trouble.

Is there any real difference between "Ahhh!" and "Yuk!"?

What about "good" and "evil"?

Must I fear what others fear?

Ridiculous!

Everybody else is smiling,

having fun as if at a festival or carnival.

I alone am drifting, not knowing whether I'm coming or going,

like a baby before it has

enough.

I alone seem to have lost all.

I must be a fool, so indiscriminate and nebulous.

Most people seem knowledgeable and bright.

I alone am simple and dull.

Most people see differences and are sharp.

I alone make no distinctions,

seeming aimless, drifting as the sea,

like the wind blowing about, seemingly without destination.

People of the world all have a purpose.

I alone seem impractical and out of place.

I am different from others,

and value drawing sustenance from the Mother.

Am I the one who is a misguided fool?

When everyone else is exuberant, I continue to be disinterested. When everyone else is alert to the niceties of etiquette, I persist in being indifferent. I am as unconcerned as the rolling ocean, without a care to bother me.

While others behave like busybodies, I alone remain placid and resist arousement. How can I withstand the pressure of public opinion? Because I am succored by Mother Nature herself.

to anything and don't have to go anywhere in particular

The others already have so much and still they want more

Only I seem to have lost everything

They think I'm crazy and confused

People seem to be bright and clever

And think that I am naive and foolish

It looks like I blow with the wind and don't seem to find rest anywhere

The others seem to know so much

And in their eyes I am nothing but a boor

I am only different because I live according to my nature

The profane man hath his need filled,

ay, and more also. For me, I seem to have lost all I had. My mind is as

it were stupefied; it hath no definite shape. The profane man looketh

lively and keen-witted; I alone appear blank in my mind. They seem

eagerly critical; I appear careless and without perception. I seem to be

as one adrift upon the sea, with {24} no thought of an harbor. The

profane have each one his definite course of action; I alone appear

useless and uncomprehending, like a man from the border. Yea, thus I

learned to smile.

Others have what they need; I have nothing.

I might as well be homeless.

I'm a fool. Very confused.

Others are bright; I am dim.

Others are sharp; I am dull, lost at sea, without direction.

Others have plans; I am aimless.

I am different from others.

I am nourished by the Great Mother.

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Within the Elusive Way

All-embracing power proceeds only through the Way.

What is called the Way is elusive and intangible.

Intangible and elusive, yet within it are thought-images.

Elusive and intangible, yet within it are objects.

Deep and obscure, yet within it is the life-force.

Intelligence consists in acting according to Nature.

Nature is something which can neither be seen nor touched. Yet all of the forms which can possibly be seen or touched are latent within it. And all of the things that will actually be seen or touched are embedded as potentialities within it. Deep in its depths are activating forces.

A righteous and blissful life is approachable only when you follow your conscience

The conscience is invisible and impalpable. How can you follow it?

It speaks through images, like shadows in the dark

But how faintly and obscurely

The conscience is hidden but it carries the essentials of everything

THE INFINITE WOMB

The sole source of energy is the Tao. Who may declare its nature? It is beyond Sense, yet all form is hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet

all Perceptibles are hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet all

Perceptibles are hidden within it.

Te flows from Tao.

Tao is elusive and evasive.

Evasive and elusive, yet within it there are ideas.

Elusive and evasive, yet within it are entities.

Dark and obscure, yet within it there is life.

The

The life-force is very real, and within it is certainty.

From the ancient times till now

its manifestations have never ceased, by which we may see the beginning of all things.

How do I know that the beginnings of all things are so?

Through this certainty.

No matter how unplumbable the depths, these forces unfailingly sustain the world as it appears to us.

From the beginning until now, they have never ceased to express themselves in appearances.

How do I know all this to be so? It is intuitively self-evident, for every existing thing testifies to it, including what appears right here and now.

inside

The true life-force shelters itself inside conscience

Everything people know deeply inside is stowed within the conscience

It has always been there since the beginning, with many different names

The conscience separates truth from lie

How do I know all this?

My conscience has told me that it's so

It is beyond Sense, yet all Being is hidden within it. This Being excites Perception, and the Word thereof.

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, its Name

operateth continuously, causing all to flow in the cycle of Change, which

is Love and Beauty. How do I know this? By my comprehension of the Tao.

life of the Tao is so real; it gives rise to certainty.

From the beginning until now, it has appeared in countless forms, it has been given countless names.

How do I know this? Like this!

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Yielding for Unity

To yield is to preserve unity.

To bend is to become straight.

To empty oneself is to become full.

To wear oneself out is to be renewed.

To have little is to be content.

To have abundance is to be troubled.

Therefore the wise embrace the One

and become examples for the world.

They do not display

Submit to Nature if you would reach your goal. For, whoever deviates from Nature's way, nature forces back again. Whoever gives up his desire to improve upon Nature will find Nature satisfying all his needs. Whoever finds his desires extinguished will find more desires arising of their own accord. Whoever desires little is easily satisfied. Whoever desires much suffers frustration.

Therefore, the intelligent person is at one with Nature, and so serves as a model for others.

Dissension becomes unity

The impure becomes pure

The voids shall be filled

The old becomes new

One who has nothing, receives everything

One who has a lot, receives nothing

One who is wise cherishes simplicity and in this way he is an example to the world

He is modest

THE GUERDON OF MODESTY

The part becometh the whole. The curve becometh straight; the void becometh full; the old becometh new. He who desireth little accomplisheth his Will with ease; who desireth many things becometh distracted.

Therefore, the sage concentrateth upon one Will, and it is as a light to the whole world.

To be whole, let yourself break.

To be straight, let yourself bend.

To be full, let yourself be empty.

To be new, let yourself wear out.

To have everything, give everything up.

The Tao—Master clings to the Tao and becomes a model for all.

He doesn't put on a show, but his light

themselves and are therefore illumined.

They do not justify themselves and are distinguished.

They do not make claims and are therefore given credit.

They do not seek glory and therefore are leaders.

Because they do not compete,

the world cannot compete with them.

Is not the ancient saying true,

"To yield is to preserve unity?"

By not asserting that he is right, he does the right thing. By not boasting of what he will do, he succeeds in doing more than he promises.

By not gloating over his successes, his achievements are acclaimed by others. By not competing with others, he achieves without opposition.

Therefore the old saying is not idle talk: "Submit to Nature if you would reach your goal." For that is the only genuine way.

and therefore he excels

He doesn't have to prove himself and that's why people trust his words

He has nothing to defend and therefore he is invulnerable

So the aphorism of the wise of old "The imperfect becomes perfect" is true

The perfect considers the world as his home

Hiding himself, he shineth; withdrawing himself, he attracteth notice; humbling himself, he is exalted; dissatisfied with himself, he gaineth force to achieve his Will. Because he striveth not,

no man may contend against him.

That is no idle saw of the men of old; 'The part becometh the whole'; it is the Canon of Perfection.

shines forth.

He doesn't justify himself, but he is known for his integrity.

He doesn't boast, but he is recognized as accomplished.

He doesn't contend with others, and thus no one contends with him.

The old saying, "Surrender and conquer," is not an empty slogan.

Surrender to the Tao and find yourself completed.

. Nature Nature says few words. A whirlwind does not last all morning, nor does a rainstorm last a whole day. What causes them? Nature. If even Nature's utterances do not last long, how much less should human beings? Those who follow the Way are one with the Way.	Things which act naturally do not need to be told how to act. The wind and rain begin without being ordered, and quit without being commanded. This is the way with all natural beginnings and endings. If Nature does not have to instruct the wind and the rain, how much less should man try to	One who knows oneself doesn't need a lot of words A whirlwind doesn't last all morning A shower doesn't last a whole day Where do wind and rain come from? They sprout from nature If nature doesn't endure its rains and storms Then why should a human being have to talk so much?	THE VOID OF NAUGHT To keep silence is the mark of one who is acting in full accordance with his Will. A fierce wind soon falleth; a storm-shower doth not last all day. Yet Heaven and Earth cause these; and if they fail to make violence continue, how much less can man abide in spasm of passion! With him that devoteth him to Tao, the devotees of Tao are in	Much talk is contrary to nature. The wind doesn't blow all morning. The rain doesn't fall all day. Wind and rain are caused by nature, If nature restrains herself, shouldn't people do the same? He who follows the Tao is one with the Tao. He who is virtuous
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Those who follow power are one with power. Those who abandon it are one with abandonment. Those one with the Way are welcomed by the Way. Those one with power are welcomed by power. Those one with abandonment are welcomed by abandonment. Those who lack trust will not be trusted.	direct them? Whoever acts naturally is Nature itself acting. And whoever acts unintelligently is unintelligence in action. By acting naturally, one reaps Nature's rewards. So by acting intelligently, one achieves intelligent goals. Whereas by acting unintelligently, one comes to an unintelligent end. Those who do not trust Nature as a model cannot be trusted as guides.	So the One who follows his conscience, coincides with his conscience One who lives an exemplary life, will be an example One who loses oneself, doesn't know who he is anymore One who finds oneself, finds bliss One who loses oneself, loses true life One who does not trust oneself, will not be trusted	accord; so also are the devotees of Teh, yea, even they who fail in seeking those are in accord. So then his brothers in the Tao are joyful, attaining it; and his brothers in the Teh are joyful, attaining it; and they who fail in seeking these are joyful, partaking of it. But if he himself realize not the Tao with calm of confidence, then they also appear lacking in confidence.	is one with Virtue [Te]. He who loses the Tao becomes a loss. Surrender to the Tao, and it will be your home. Practice virtue [Te], and it will be your abode. Lose the Tao, and you will then reside in loss. No trust given, no trust received.
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. Avoid Excess Those who stand on tiptoe are not steady. Those who strain their strides cannot long keep up the pace. Those who display themselves do not illuminate. Those who justify themselves are not distinguished.	One who tries to stand on tiptoe cannot stand still. One who stretches his legs too far cannot walk. One who advertises himself to much is ignored. One who is too insistent on his own views finds few to agree with him. One who claims too much credit does not get even what he deserves.	One who stands on tiptoe, doesn't stand firmly One who walks in a forced way, doesn't come far One who is vain, doesn't shine One who justifies oneself, isn't credible One who	EVIL MANNERS He who standeth a-tiptoe standeth not firm; he who maketh rigid his legs walketh ill. He who preeneth himself shineth not; he who talketh positively is vulgar; he who boastheth is refused acceptance; he who is wise in his own conceit is thought inferior.	He who stands on tiptoe does not stand firm. He who walks fast cannot walk far. He who shows off does not shine forth. He who pushes will
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Those who make claims are not given credit. Those who seek glory are not leaders. According to the Way these are like extra food and waste, which all creatures detest. Therefore followers of the Way avoid them.	One who is too proud is soon humiliated. These, when judged by the standards of Nature, are condemned as "Extremes of greediness and self-destructive activity." Therefore, one who acts naturally avoids such extremes.	brags, will be unmasked One who works one's way up, humiliates oneself To a wise man these are nothing but follies One who lives righteously and honestly, refrains oneself from these things	Such attitudes, to him that hath the view given by understanding the Tao, seem like garbage or like cancer, abhorrent to all. They then who follow the Way do not admit them.	not succeed. He who boasts will not achieve. He who praises his own work creates nothing that endures. These things inspire disgust. Followers of the Tao spurn them.
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The Supreme

There is something mysterious and whole which existed before heaven and earth, silent, formless, complete, and never changing.

Living eternally everywhere in perfection,

it is the mother of all things.

I do not know its name; I call it the Way.

If forced to define it, I shall call it supreme.

Supreme means absolute.

Absolute

There exists something which is prior to all beginnings and endings, Which, unmoved and unmanifest, itself neither begins nor ends. All-pervasive and inexhaustible, it is the perpetual source of everything else,

For want of a better name, I call it Nature. If I am forced to describe it, I speak of it as "ultimate reality."

Before Creation revealed itself

There was already something, perfect but formless

Quiet and unchanging

Ubiquitous and inexhaustible

People might consider it as the creating force of everything that is

I cannot describe it, but I just call it Tao

If I have to interpret it , I would name it "The Universe"

With that Universe I mean that which extends itself everywhere

IMAGES OF THE MYSTERY

Without Limit and Perfect, there is a Becoming, beyond Heaven and Earth.

It hath nor motion nor Form; it is alone, it changeth not; it extendeth

all ways; it hath no Adversary. It is like the All-Mother.

I know not its Name, but I call it the Tao. Moreover, I exert myself,

and call it Vastness.

Vastness, the Becoming!

Before the birth of Heaven and Earth, there was something without form but complete.

Silent. Empty. Independent. Unchanging. Infinite. Eternal.

It is the Mother of all things.

I cannot classify it, but I call it Tao.

Powerful, it creates all things, is

means extending everywhere.

Extending everywhere means returning to itself.

Thus the Way is supreme.

Heaven is supreme.

Earth is supreme.

And the person is supreme.

There are four supremes in the universe,

and the person is one of them.

The person reflects the earth.

The earth reflects heaven.

Heaven reflects the Way.

whence it came.

Nature is ultimate, the principle of initiating is ultimate, and the principle of perfecting is ultimate. And the intelligent person is also ultimate. Four kinds of ultimate, then, exist, and the intelligent man is one of them.

returning

Therefore the creative is great and the creation great and so is a wise man

So there is a trinity of greatnesses and one of them is the true human being

A true human being follows his nature, nature and all its eternally unchanging laws

The laws of nature are the eternal order of the Universe

The order of the Universe is well-founded by the Unnameable

Becoming, it flieth afar. Afar, it draweth near. Vast is this Tao; Heaven also is Vast; Earth is vast; and the Holy

King is vast also. In the Universe are Four Vastnesses, and of these is

the Holy King.

Man followeth the formula of Earth; Earth followeth that of Heaven, and

Heaven that of the Tao. The formula of the Tao is its own Nature.

present in all things, returns all things to their origin.

The Tao is great. Heaven is great.

Earth is great. Humanity is great.

These are the four great things.

Humanity follows Earth. Earth follows Heaven.

Heaven follows Tao. Tao follows its own nature.

. Self-mastery Gravity is the foundation of levity. Serenity masters hastiness. Therefore the wise travel all day without leaving their baggage. In the midst of honor and glory	Saneness or sobriety is more basic than frivolity. Calmness or self-sufficiency is superior to being agitated. Therefore the intelligent man, though he goes on a long journey, will never depart far from his means of conveyance.	Heavy is the source of that which is light The unmoved mover is the origin of all movement Therefore a true human being can be in motion all day Not because it is him moving himself But because he just floats on life Like	THE NATURE OF MASS Mass is the fulcrum of mobility; stillness is the father of motion. Therefore the sage King, though he travel afar, remaineth near his supplies.	Heavy is the foundation of light. Stillness is the source of movement. Thus, the Tao—Master travels all day without losing sight of the baggage—cart. He is not swept away by splendid scenery. He remains quiet
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they remain leisurely and calm, How can a leader of a great country behave lightheartedly and frivolously? In frivolity, the foundation is lost. In hasty action, self-mastery is lost.	No matter how exciting the distractions, he never submits to their lures. What would happen if Nature were to act frivolously? If it became frivolous, it would be deprived of its sanity. If it became agitated, it would lose control of itself.	a spectator he enjoys the wonderful and sparkling creation Why should he, as the centre of the world, Consider himself minor to that world? One who knows his grandeur, comes loose of the world One who wanders restlessly in that world, has lost oneself	Though opportunity tempt him, he remaineth quietly in proper disposition, indifferent. Should the master of an host of chariots bear himself frivolously? If he attack without support, he loseth his base; if he become a raider, he forfeiteth his throne.	and unperturbed. Why should the lord of the land allow himself to be swept away? Allow yourself to be swept away, and you lose your foundation. Allow yourself to be moved, and you lose self—mastery.
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. Using the Light A good traveler leaves no trace. A good speaker makes no slips. A good accountant uses no devices. A good door needs no bolts to remain shut. A good fastener needs no rope to hold its bond. Therefore the wise are good at helping people, and consequently no one is rejected.	The wise traveler has no need to retrace his steps. The effective speaker does not need to repeat himself. The generous trader needs no scales. The self-closing door needs no bolt, for it will not open itself even though it is not forced to stay shut. Things which go together naturally do not have to be tied; for they will not separate even without bonds. Therefore the intelligent man expresses his beneficence to other men by accepting each man's own way as best for himself.	A true traveller never takes a beaten road A true speaker has an answer to every question A true researcher has solved all problems A story that holds water needs no confirmation Nobody can refute a watertight story One who sees how perfectly everything is connected with everything Needs no theories or opinions, and no one can bring him to doubt That's why a true human being is a teacher of others And he loves his fellow	SKILL IN THE METHOD The experienced traveler concealth his tracks; the clever speaker giveth no chance to the critic; the skilled mathematician useth no abacus; the ingenious safesmith bafflenth the burglar without the use of bolts, and the cunning binder without ropes and knots. So also the sage, skilled in man-emancipation-craft, useth all men; understanding	Following the Tao, the Tao–Master leaves no tracks, speaks without error, counts without markers. No locks on his door, and yet no one can open it. No rope used, and yet his knots cannot be untied. Thus, the Tao–Master cares for all beings and neglects
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They are good at saving things, and consequently nothing is wasted. This is called using the Light. Therefore the good teach the bad, and the bad are lessons for the good. Those who neither value the teacher nor care for the lesson are greatly deluded, though they may be learned. Such is the essential mystery.	And he performs the same service for all other beings, for he willingly recognizes that, by following its own nature, each thing does the best that can be done for it. This may be called the two-pronged lesson: Bad men can learn from the good man's successes. Good men can learn from the bad man's failures.	men unconditionally Therefore he is shepherd of the whole creation And respects every thing that lives and grows People call this: "The light that has become human" Therefore a true human being is a mirror for the untrue And it's his task to point out their imperfections One who is scared to take a look at oneself and does not love oneself Might know a lot of things, but he is blind It seems odd, but it's true	the value of everything, he rejecteth nothing. This is called the Occult Regimen. The adept is then master to the zelator, and the zelator assisteth and honoreth the adept. Yet unless these relations were manifest, even the most intelligent observer might be perplexed as to which was which. This is called the Crown of Mystery.	none. Thus, he follows the light. The Tao–Master teaches the fool; and thus the fool learns. But teaching and learning will not take place unless the student values the teacher and the teacher loves the student. This is the subtle secret of teaching and learning.
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The Valley of the World

Know the male and keep to the female.

Become the valley of the world.

Being the valley of the world is eternal power

and returning to the innocence of a baby.

Know the bright and keep to the obscure.

Become an example for the world.

Being an example for

He who knows how to be aggressive, and yet remains patient, becomes a receptacle for all Nature's lessons. Being thus receptive, he continually reembodies intelligence, and recuperates his primal nature.

He who knows how to be brilliant, and yet remains demure, becomes the ideal which all things have as their ultimate goal.

Being thus the ideal, he actualizes the unending goal of existence, and reinstates his primordial condition of perfect self —

One who knows his strength and yet stays mild, is the least

Whoever is the least, is balanced like the open-minded child he once was

One who has fathomed the lie is an example for the world

One who became human again

THE RETURN TO SIMPLICITY

Balance thy male strength with thy female weakness and thou shalt attract all things, as the ocean absorbeth all rivers; for thou shalt formulate the excellence of the Child eternal, simple, and perfect. Knowing the light,

remain in the Dark. Manifest not thy Glory, but thine obscurity. Clothed in this Child-excellence eternal, thou hast attained the Return of the First

Know the male, maintain the female: become the channel of all things.

Become the channel of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.

You will be reborn.

Know the white, maintain the black: become the form of all things.

Become the form of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.

You will

the world is eternal power

and returning to the infinite.

Know glory and keep to humility.

Become the valley of the world.

Being the valley of the world is eternal power

and returning to the natural.

Breaking up the natural makes instruments.

The wise use them and become leaders.

Therefore a leader does not break.

sufficiency.

He who know how to be proud, and yet remains humble, becomes the recipient of all Nature's bounties. Being thus receptive, he reintegrates intrinsic goodness, and restores primitive wholeness.

Intrinsic goodness, when devoted to varieties of uses, functions as instrumental value. When the intelligent man employs instrumental values, he treats them as means to ends, For he is concerned with the ultimate ends, never mistaking the means as ends in themselves.

is an example for the world

One knowing oneself, is a knowing among the ignorant

One who has returned to his original purity, realizes his grandeur

One who has abandoned his origin, becomes civilized

To the wise man they are like actors

Knowing splendour of Fame, cling to Obloquy and Infamy; then shalt thou remain as in the Valley to which flow all waters, the lodestone to fascinate all men. Yea, they shall hail in thee this Excellence, eternal, simple and perfect, of the Child.

The raw material, wrought into form, produceth vessels. So the sage

King formulateth his Wholeness in divers Offices; and his Law is without

return to the Infinite.

Know honor, maintain humility: become the valley of all things.

Become the valley of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.

You will find the simplicity of nature.

Uncarved wood, when carved by the Tao–Master, becomes a well–governed state.

The best carving is that which is not carved at all.

. Do Not Tamper with the World Those who take over the world and act upon it, I notice, do not succeed. The world is a sacred vessel, not to be tampered with. Those who tamper with it, spoil it.	Whenever someone sets out to remold the world, experience teaches that he is bound to fail. For Nature is already as good as it can be. It cannot be improved upon. He who tries to redesign it, spoils it. He who tries to redirect it, misleads it. Consider how Natures operates: Some things precede while others follow.	One who thinks he is capable of improving Creation, will not succeed Creation is perfect and cannot be corrected One who intervenes in nature, will only destroy nature One who tries to control nature, will lose to nature Because everything is what it is and	REFRAINING FROM ACTION He that, desiring a kingdom, exerteth himself to obtain it, will fail. A Kingdom is of the nature of spirit, and yieldeth not to activity. He who graspeth it, destroyeth it; he who gaineth it, loseth	Do you think you can control the world? I don't think so. The world belongs to the Tao. It can't be controlled. If you mess with it, you'll ruin it. If you try to grab it, you'll
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Those who seize it, lose it. Some lead, and some follow. Some blow hot, and some blow cold. Some are strong, and some are weak. Some are up, and some are down. Therefore the wise avoid excess, extravagance, and pride.	Some things blow one way while some blow another. Some things are strong while others are weak. Some things are going up while others are going down. Therefore the intelligent man avoids both extremes, shunning excess in one way as well as in the other.	everything happens as it happens At times it is warm and then it is cold At times there are storms and then it's calm There is growth and then there is lying down A wise man lets himself flow along with the streams of life	it. The wheel of nature revolveth constantly; the last becometh first, and the first last; hot things grow cold, and cold things hot; weakness overcometh strength; things gained are lost anon. Hence the wise man avoideth effort, desire and sloth.	lose it. Some things move on; others remain behind; some things are hot; others are cold; some things are strong; others are weak; some things are up; others are down. The Tao—Master renounces extremes, excess, and extravagance.
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Force of Arms

Whoever advises a leader according to the Way

opposes conquest by force of arms.

The use of force tends to rebound.

Where armies march, thorns and brambles grow.

Whenever a great army is formed, scarcity and famine follow.

The skillful achieve their purposes and stop.

They dare not rely on force.

They achieve

Whoever tries to help Nature run itself does not need to use force. For force will be met with force, and wherever force is used fighting and devastation follows.

After the battle come years of destitution.

He who is wise lets well enough alone. He does not press a victory by further conquest.

When peace has been restored, he does not behave like an arrogant victor.

One who advocates a righteous world, uses no violence

Because One who uses violence, provokes violence

And where discord rules there is chaos

And after times of conflict lean years will follow

The righteous one does what he can and forces nothing

Is not proud about what he achieves

Does

A WARNING AGAINST WAR

If a king summon to his aid a Master of the Tao, let Him not advise

recourse to arms. Such action certainly bringeth the corresponding reaction.

Where armies are, are weeds. Bad harvests follow great hosts.

The good general striketh decisively, once and for all.

How to govern in accordance with the Tao:

No conquest by force of arms.

Weapons always turn back against themselves.

Encamp an army today;

the campground is all thorns and brambles tomorrow.

Make war for a month; there will be famine for years.

Do what

their purposes, but do not glory in them.

They achieve their purposes, but do not celebrate them.

They achieve their purposes, but do not take pride in them.

They achieve their purposes, but without violence.

Things reach their prime and then decline.

Violence is contrary to the Way.

Whatever is contrary to the Way will soon perish.

When security has been regained, he does not gloat like a conqueror. When he gets what he needs, he does not destroy those who have been defeated. Whenever he does something which he has to do, he does it without cruelty.

When things reach maturity, they decay of themselves. So cruelty is unnatural. Whoever acts unnaturally will come to an unnatural finish.

not brag about what he achieves

Does not boast about what he achieves

He only does what he does because that's all he can do

And he never uses power or violence

Civilizations which have reached their peaks

Usher in their decay

Civilizations are unnatural

And what's unnatural, will perish

He does not risk by overboldness. He striketh, but doth not vaunt his victory. He

striketh according to strict law of necessity, not from desire of victory

Things become strong and ripe, then age. This is discord with the

Tao; and what is not at one with the Tao soon cometh to an end.

needs to be done, but do not rejoice in victory.

Make war, if necessary, and win,

but without arrogance, without hostility, without pride,

without needless violence.

War, victory, and the rest do not last.

They are contrary to Tao.

What is contrary to Tao perishes quickly.

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War and Peace

Weapons are tools of destruction hated by people.

Therefore followers of the Way never use them.

In peace leaders favor the creative left.

In war they favor the destructive right.

Weapons are tools of destruction,

not used by good leaders.

When their use cannot

Weapons have a negative value, for they create fear in others. Therefore, the follower of Nature avoids them.

For when among intimates, one naturally prefers the gentler, more trusting, position on the left. And when among enemies, one naturally jockey for the more strategic position on the right.

Since weapons have a negative value, the intelligent man will have nothing to do with them if he can. But when he is forced to use them, he does so with reluctance and restraint.

He does not admire conquest. For whoever desires to conquer desires to kill.

How ingenious weaponry may seem to be, though it will always be disastrous rubbish

Everybody hates it

A righteous man saves himself from it

While a true man will not soil his hands with it

A fighter grabs for it

Weapons are not good for meek people

They bring nothing but trouble

One who is wise will never ever use a weapon

Because peace and quietness are more precious

COMPOSING QUARREL

Arms, though they be beautiful, are of ill omen, abominable to all

created beings. They who have the Tao love not their use.

The place of honour is on the right in wartime; so thinketh the man of

distinction. Sharp weapons are ill-omened, unworthy of such a man; he useth them only in necessity. He valueth peace and ease, desireth not

violence of victory. To desire victory is to desire the death of men; and

Weapons generate fear; all creatures hate them.

Therefore, the Tao–Master tries not to use them

He uses them only when there is no alternative,

and then without joy, in

be avoided,

the best policy is calm restraint.

Even in victory there is no glory.

Those who celebrate victory delight in slaughter.

Those who delight in slaughter

will not be successful leaders.

The killing of many should be mourned with sorrow.

A victory should be celebrated with funeral ceremonies.

And whoever delights in murder, cannot inherit the earth.

When things go well, we signify this by honouring the position on the left. When ills prevail, we symbolize this by giving precedence to the position on the right. In military parades, the second in command, who is ordered to give orders, takes his place on the left, While the first in command, who by himself undertakes to give orders, takes the right hand position. There is a significant similarity between fighting and funerals.

Just as the slaughter of many people should be accomplished by weeping and mourning, So the positions in a victory parade should properly parallel those in a funeral procession.

to him

He doesn't enjoy victory

Because one who enjoys victory

Enjoys his fellow men getting killed

And one who enjoys their fellow men getting killed

Will never find peace in oneself

Prosperity is considered as a personal merit

Misfortune on the other hand is considered as an ironic freak

Victory is the merit of men

And defeat the blame of the commander

to desire that is to fail to propitiate the people.

At feasts, the left hand is the high seat; at funerals, the right. The

second in command of the army leadeth the left wing, the commander-in-

chief, the right wing; it is as if the battle were a rite of mourning!

He that hath slain most men should weep for them most bitterly; so then

the place of the victor is assigned to him with philosophical propriety.

a calm and restrained way.

Enjoy weapons, enjoy killing.

Enjoy killing, lose yourself

The killing of many people should create sorrow and grief.

A great victory is a funeral ceremony.

The Natural Way
The Way is absolute
and undefined.
Like natural
uncarved wood in
simplicity,
yet none in the world
can overcome it.
If leaders would hold
to it,
the whole world
would serve them
spontaneously.
Heaven and earth
join, and gentle rain

Nature is always
indeterminable.
Although, in its
original simplicity, it
may appear to be
helpless, no one else
can tell it what to do.
If legislators and
administrators could
keep this in mind,
everybody would
obey their laws
without enforcement.
When opposites
supplement each
other, everything is
harmonious. Without
compulsion, each
supports the other.
But when boundaries
between opposites
appear, then the
boundary lines are
marked out.

The Unspeakable is
eternal and is not to
be spoken of in
words
Just like a rough
piece of wood, it's
not useful to anyone
If leaders were an
example of true
living
Everyone would join
his true nature at the
same time
The heavens would
dew and the clouds
rain justice
And without human
intervening
That altogether
would

THE WISDOM OF
THE
The All-Tao hath no
name.
It is That Minute
Point yet the whole
world dare not
contend
against him that hath
it. Did a lord or king
gain it and guard it,
all
men would obey him
of their own accord.
Heaven and Earth
combining under its
spell, shed forth dew,
extending

The Tao cannot be
named or defined.
It is invisible, but it
contains all things.
If rulers could master
it, then everything
would fall into place.
Heaven and Earth
would be united.
A sweet rain would
fall.
People would be just
without regulation.
However, when

falls,
beyond the command
of anyone, evenly
upon all.
When civilization
arose, names began.
With names, one
should know when to
stop.
Knowing when to
stop, frees one from
danger.
The Way in the
world is like
rivers and streams
flowing into the sea.

Once one begins to
differentiate between
one thing and
another, how will we
know where to stop?
To know when to
stop making
distinctions is to be
free from error.
The true relationship
of every determinate
thing to Nature is
reintegrative, like all
the rivers and rivulets
ever running to their
ocean.

benefit every single
thing that lives
beneath the
firmament
But when discord is
born
Everything must
have a name
Keep in mind that
when everything has
a name,
You'll have to stop
all that
Because one who
stops will bounce off
danger
Compared to the
twisted tributaries of
mistake
The straight and
simple road is like a
powerful stream

throughout all things
of its own accord,
without man's
interference.
Tao, in its phase of
action, hath a name.
Then men can
comprehend it;
when they do this,
there is no more risk
of wrong or
ill-success.
As the great rivers
and the oceans are to
the valley streams, so
is the
Tao to the whole
universe.

people seek to rule,
they divide the whole
and begin assigning
names to things.
And now, there are
names upon names.
Too many!
The naming must
stop.
Knowing when to
stop saves us from
danger.
Tao in the world is
like rivers flowing
into the sea.

. Inner Power Those who know others are wise. Those who know themselves are enlightened. Those who overcome others require force. Those who overcome themselves need strength. Those	He who knows much about others may be learned, but he who understands himself is more intelligent. He who controls others may be powerful, but he who has mastered himself is mightier still. He who receives his happiness from others may	One who sees trough the other is clever One knowing oneself is wise One who conquers the other is powerful One conquering oneself is inviolable One who is satisfied	THE DISCRIMINATION (VIVEKA) OF THE He who understandeth others understandeth Two; but he who understandeth himself understandeth One. He who conquereth others is strong; but he who conquereth himself is stronger yet.	Knowing others is a kind of knowledge; knowing yourself is wisdom. Conquering others requires strength; conquering yourself is true power [Te]. To realize
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who are content are wealthy. Those who persevere have will power. Those who do not lose their center endure. Those who die but maintain their power live eternally.	be rich, but he who whose contentment is self-willed has inexhaustible wealth. He who occupies a place provided for him by others may live a long life, but he who dwells in his own self-contained place, even though he decays, is eternal.	is rich One that wants a lot is busy all the time One who stays oneself, is a four-square fellow One who dies before dying, lives in the present forever	Contentment is riches; and continuous action is Will. He that adapteth himself perfectly to his environment, continueth for long; he who dieth without dying, liveth for ever.	that you have enough is true wealth. Pushing ahead may succeed, but staying put brings endurance. Die without perishing, and find the eternal.
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The Great Way

The great Way flows everywhere, both left and right.

All things derive their life from it, and it does not turn away from them.

It accomplishes its work, but does not take possession.

It provides

Ultimate reality is all-pervasive; it is immanent everywhere.

All other things owe their existence to it and draw their sustenance from it, without anyone being refused. Having created and and nurtured them, it does not demand title to them. Even though it has provided for all, it refuses to dominate over a single one.

Since it

That which makes everything exist, is present everywhere

It spreads itself throughout the entire Creation

Everything owes its existence to It, everything to its own nature

It gives everything for nothing

It cherishes and guards everything and everyone, but expects nothing

THE METHOD OF ATTAINMENT

The Tao is immanent; it extendeth to the right hand as to the left.

All things derive from it their being; it createth them, and all comply

with it. Its work is done, and it proclaimeth it not. It is the

ornament of all things, yet it claimeth not fief of them;

The Tao is like an overflowing river.

It rises to the left and to the right.

The ten thousand things arise from it, but do not depart from it.

The Tao acts, but cannot be defined.

It clothes and nourishes all beings, but does not

for and nourishes everything,

but does not control them.

Always without desires, it may be considered small.

The destination of all things, yet claiming nothing,

it may be considered great.

Because it never claims greatness, its greatness is achieved.

asks nothing in return for its services, it may appear as of little worth.

But all things return home to it again, even though they do not know that they are being called home. Therefore it may be thought of as ultimate.

Since it never claims ultimacy for itself, it is, by that very fact, ultimate indeed.

in return

Because It does not wish for anything, It seems to be important

It makes everything appear and disappear again

But Itself is eternal

Therefore the one who is wise is modest

And because he is modest,

His actions are grand

there is

nothing so small that it inhabiteth not, and informeth it.

All things return without knowledge of the Cause thereof; there is

nothing so great that it inhabiteth not, and informeth it.

In this manner also may the Sage perform his Works. It is by not

thrusting himself forward that he winneth to his success.

rule over them.

It endures without desire and without seeming "big."

The ten thousand things find their home in it, and yet it does not exercise lordship over them.

The Tao is very great, but it does not show its greatness.

Therefore, it is truly great.

. The Inexhaustible Way Hold to the great form, and all the world follows, following without meeting harm, in health, peace, and happiness. Music and delicacies to	He who grasps the ultimate structure of reality draws everyone to him. They approach him without being harmed, but find security, satisfaction, and contentment. Particular goods of various kinds attract the interests of men as they travel through life. But the all-pervasive way of Nature attracts no attention to itself (for its true nature is not found to be in particulars).	For one who beholds the perfect arrangement of things Everything falls in its rightful place Nothing can harm him, and rest and peace will fall to him Along the	THE GOOD WILL OF THE TEH The whole world is drawn to him that hath the likeness of the Tao. Men flock unto him, and suffer no ill, but gain repose, find peace, enjoy	Kapitel nicht vorhanden
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eat induce travelers to stay. But the Way is mild to the taste. Looked at, it is invisible. Listened to, it is inaudible. Applied, it is inexhaustible.	Even though it is present in the mouth, it remains untasted. Even though it is embedded in all objects, it remains unseen. Even though it permeates sound, it remains unheard. Yet, no matter how much we use it, it can never be exhausted.	way there are travellers who yield music and feasts Because the road to self-knowledge is acrid and unpleasant Not pleasant to face Painful to hear But giving an inexhaustible strength	all ease. Sweet sounds and cates lure the traveler from his way. But the Word of the Tao; though it appear harsh and insipid, unworthy to hearken or to behold; hath his use all inexhaustible.	/ chapter not available
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. The Mystic Light In order to contract, it is necessary first to expand. In order to weaken, it is necessary first to strengthen. In order to reduce, it is necessary first to build up. In order to	The purpose of contracting (returning to Nature) is served by expanding (emerging out of Nature in the first place). The purpose of weakening (subsiding or satisfying of desire) is served by strengthening (arousing the will to live). The purpose of decline (of individual self-assertion) is served by arising (of individuality).	Only what's stretched out can be pulled together Only what's fortified can be weakened Only what's increased can be decreased Only one	THE HIDING OF THE LIGHT In order to draw breath, first empty the lungs; to weaken another, first strengthen him; to overthrow another, first exalt him; to despoil another, first load him with gifts;	To shrink, you must first expand. To weaken, you must first strengthen. To knock down, you must first raise up. To receive, you must first give.
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receive, it is necessary first to give. This is called the mystic Light. The soft and gentle overcome the hard and strong. As fish stay in the deep water, so sharp weapons of the state should not be displayed.	The purpose of taking away (culminating or perfecting life) is served by being given (ie., "the last of life for which the first was made"). This is the most penetrating insight into the way of life. The giving in or finishing always triumphs over the starting out. Just as a fish should not be taken out of water, So a sword should never be taken from its scabbard.	who has, can lose That must be clear Soft overcomes hard Weak overcomes strong Fishes belong in water Weapons have to be destroyed	this is called the Occult Regimen. The soft conquereth the hard; the weak pulleth down the strong. The fish that leaveth ocean is lost; the method of government must be concealed from the people.	This is the way things are. Soft overcomes hard. Slow overcomes fast. Fish cannot live out of the water. A nation's best weapons should not be displayed.
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The Way Never
Interferes
The Way never
interferes,
yet through it
everything is done.
If leaders would
follow the Way,
the world would be
reformed of its own
accord.
When reformed and

Nature never acts, yet
it activates
everything.
If legislators and
administrators would
behave likewise,
each thing would
develop in
accordance with its
own nature.

The Eternal Creating
does nothing
And yet it does
everything
If leaders would give
in to it
The aspect of the
world would change
of itself
But since people
have

THE RIGHT USE
OF GOVERNMENT
The Tao proceedeth
by its own nature,
doing nothing;
therefore there is
no doing which it
comprehendeth not.
If kings and princes
were to govern in this
manner,

The Tao never acts,
yet through it
everything gets done.
If rulers could reside
in the Tao,
everything would fall
into

desiring to act,
let them be restrained
by what is simply
natural.
Undefined simplicity
is free of desires.
Being free of desires,
it is serene;
and the world finds
peace of its own
accord.

Just as, when things
develop, those which
become passionate
are restrained by that
passionless one
which activates them,
So the way to restrain
men's passions is by
dispassionate
restraint. And thus all
passions will subside.

so much to wish for
Only I can be an
example
The example of true
simplicity
And when the people
decide to follow me
The whole world will
be in peace

all things would
operate aright by
their own motion.
If this transmutation
were my object, I
should call it
Simplicity.
Simplicity hath no
name nor purpose;
silently and at ease
all things go
well.

place all by itself.
Action is restrained
by the Tao.
Action restrained, no
desire.
No desire:
tranquillity.
All things at peace.

.

The Superior

Superior power does not emphasize its power, and thus is powerful.

Inferior power never forgets its power, and thus is powerless.

Superior power never interferes nor has an ulterior motive.

Inferior power interferes and has an ulterior motive.

Superior humanity takes action but has no ulterior motive.

Superior morality takes action and has an ulterior motive.

Superior custom takes action, and finding no response,

stretches out arms to force it on them.

Therefore when

Intelligent control appears as uncontrol or freedom. And for that reason it is genuinely intelligent control. Unintelligent control appears as external domination. And for that reason it is really unintelligent control.

Intelligent control exerts influence without appearing to do so. Unintelligent control tries to influence by making a show of it.

The generous giver gives because he wants to give. The dutiful giver gives because he wants to receive. Whenever a regulation is imposed from above, it is not willingly obeyed. Then effort is used to enforce it.

But when Nature's spontaneous activity disappears, then intelligent action is called for.

True virtues are not from this world,

Therefore they are true virtues

The so-called "virtues" in this world

Serve only self-interest

Therefore those are not true virtues

One who only serves the general interest, is truthfully adequate

One who is called charitable in this world,

Expects thankfulness in return

One who is called honest in this world,

Has a hidden agenda

Those who have been adapted to this world

Demand that others do the same

And —

CONCERNING THE THE

Those who possessed perfectly the powers did not manifest them,

and so they preserved them. Those who possessed them imperfectly feared

to lose them, and so lost them.

The former did nothing, nor had need to do. The latter did, and had

need to do.

Those who possessed benevolence exercised it, and had need it; so also

was it with them who possessed justice.

Those who possessed the conventions displayed them; and when men would

The Tao—Master does not cling to power

and is therefore truly powerful.

The lesser man clings to power and thus has none.

The truly powerful man does nothing [i.e., he practices non—ado (wu—wei)]

and thus leaves nothing undone.

The lesser man is awlirl with activity

and thus gets nothing accomplished.

The virtuous man does what is good as an end in itself.

The moral man has a need to do what is good.

The man of propriety (li) makes doing good into a ritual,

and if people do

the Way is lost, power arises.

When power is lost, humanity arises.

When humanity is lost, morality arises.

When morality is lost, custom arises.

Now custom is a superficial expression

of loyalty and faithfulness, and the beginning of disorder.

Foreknowledge is the flowering of the Way

and the beginning of folly.

Therefore the mature dwell in the depth, not in the thin, in the fruit and not in the flowering.

They reject one and accept the other.

But when intelligent action is unavailable, then intuitive generosity may be appealed to. But when intuitive sympathy is lacking, principles of morality may be invoked. But where morality is ineffective, laws are enacted.

But where law is enforced, spontaneous and sincere loyalty declines, and disintegration of the harmonious society sets in. Thus valuing law as an end in itself results in minimizing fidelity to Nature itself. Knowledge of law appears at once as a flowering of Nature's way and as the source of error.

if not they threaten you and get

angry

Therefore, when people stray from the straight and simple road

Then they start to act virtuously, but they are not virtuous

They pretend to be honest, but they are not fair

They act decently, but they are not decent

Civilization is just a thin crust across unfaithfulness and dishonesty

It is also the source of disorder and chaos

A wise man never hides behind a mask

He trusts what's inside of him, not in appearances

Therefore he rejects appearance and embraces the essence

made ready to fight them.

Thus, when the Tao was lost, the Magick Powers appeared; then, by successive degradations, came Benevolence, Justice, Convention.

Now convention is the shadow of loyalty and good will, and so the herald

of disorder. Yea, even Understanding is but a Blossom of the Tao, and foreshadoweth Stupidity.

So then the Tao-Man holdeth to Mass, and avoideth Motion; he is attached

to the Root, not to the flower. He leaveth the one, and cleaveth to the other.

not follow him willingly, he forces them into line.

Thus, when the Tao is lost, virtue arises.

When virtue is lost, morality arises.

When morality is lost, justice arises.

When justice is lost, propriety arises.

Propriety is merely a shadow of justice, morality, and virtue; it is the beginning of chaos

Therefore, the Tao—Master stays with the Tao.

He does not live on the surface of things.

He looks to the fruit, not to the flower.

He accepts this [Tao] and rejects that [non—Tao].

Chapter 39
Sanderson Beck

Oneness

The ancients attained oneness.

Heaven attained oneness and became clear.

Earth attained oneness and became stable.

Spirits attained oneness and became divine.

The valleys attained oneness and became fertile.

Creatures attained oneness and lived and grew.

Kings and nobles attained oneness and became leaders.

What made them so is oneness.

Without clarity, heaven would crack.

Without stability, the earth would quake.

Without divinity, spirits would dissipate.

Without fertility, the valleys would

Chapter 39
Archie J. Bahm

There are things that have always maintained their own self-activity. The tendency to initiate is, by its self-activity, obviously self-originating. The tendency towards completion is, by its self-activity, always self-perfection. The tendency to maintain integrity, by its self-activity, sustains integrity. The tendency to oppose is, by its self-activity, sufficient for all opposition.

It is by self-activity that all things fulfill themselves. So it is by self-activity that the world is governed. Such is the extent of self-activity.

Chapter 39
Anonymous

About the men of old that had reached perfection

We know that they felt one with the whole creation

That they saw the earth not as chaos but as a unity

That they felt like gods and spiritual beings

That emptiness was no longer empty, but filled

And they saw that the whole creation was inspired

Thanks to their wholeness the world returned to its original order

For one who doesn't see clearly, the creation is splintered

For one who places oneself outside

Chapter 39
Aleister Crowley

THE LAW OF THE BEGINNING

These things have possessed the Tao from the beginning: Heaven, clear and

shining; Earth, steady and easy; Spirits, mighty in Magic;

Vehicles, overflowing with Joy; all that hath life; and the rulers of men.

All these derive their essence from the Tao.

Without the Tao, Heaven would dissolve Earth disrupt, Spirits become

impotent; Vehicles empty; living things would perish and rulers lose

their

Chapter 39
George Cronk

In archaic times, by attaining the One,

Heaven became clear;

Earth became stable;

spirit became transcendent;

valleys became full;

the ten thousand things became alive;

rulers made the country ordered and secure.

This implies that

If Heaven lacked clarity, it would be divided;

If the Earth lacked stability, it would be shaky;

If spirit lacked transcendence, it would be used up;

If valleys lacked fullness, they would be depleted;

be barren.

Without life and growth, creatures would die off.

Without leadership, kings and nobles would fall.

Therefore humility is the basis for nobility,

and the low is the basis for the high.

Thus kings and nobles call themselves

orphans, lonely, and unworthy.

Do they not depend upon the common people for support?

Dismantle the parts of a chariot, and there is no chariot.

Rather than tinkle like jade, rumble like rocks.

If the tendency toward opposition were not sustained, vitality would disappear.

If there were no self-activity, life would cease. If self activity did not govern, then disruption would set in.

The esteemed must depend upon others for their esteem, whereas the unesteemed are self-sufficient. The high must depend on the low for its foundations, whereas the low serves as its own foundation.

Therefore intelligent leaders consider themselves as independent, self-sufficient, and unesteemed. For, must not the unesteemed be the basis for the esteemed?

Therefore the unesteemed are the ultimate in esteem.

nature, the earth is chaos

One who doesn't experience oneself as divine anymore, feels powerless

One who does not experience one's perfection anymore, feels empty

People who deny their true nature, go to rack and ruin

Therefore they say:

Humility is the source of truthfulness

Smallness the source of grandeur

One who feels elevated over ones fellow men

Isn't right, is unworthy and small

After all, they climbed up high over other people's backs

power.

The root of grandeur is humility, and the strength of exaltation in its

base. Thus rulers speak of themselves as 'Fatherless,' 'Virtueless,'

'Unworthy,' proclaiming by this that their Glory is in their shame. So

also the virtue of a Chariot is not any of the parts of a Chariot, if they be

numbered. They do not seek to appear fine like jade, but inconspicuous like

common stone.

away;

and if rulers lacked nobility, they would fall,

and the country would be collapse into chaos.

Therefore, the humble is be root of the noble;

the lowly is the foundation of the high;

rulers call themselves "orphans," "widows," and "worthless."

This is taking the humble and the lowly as the root and foundation,

is it not?

You can have all the parts of a chariot without having a chariot.

Better to rumble like rocks than to tinkle like jade.

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Movement of the Way

Returning is the movement of the Way.

Gentleness is the method

Nature alternates dynamically.

One who deviates from the right and simple road

Will be pulled towards it again

This occurs

OMITTING UTILITY

The Tao proceeds by correlative curves, and its might is in

Reversal is the motion of the Tao.

Yielding is the way

of the Way.

All things in the world come from being,

and being comes from non-being.

When it completes what it is doing, then it starts all over again.

All that is springs from such alternation.

with a mild touch

The whole creation comes into existence

The existing out of the unnameable unexisting

weakness.

All things arose from the Teh, and the Teh budded from the Tao.

of the Tao.

All things emerge from being.

Being emerges from non-being.

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What the Way is Like

When the wise hear the Way, they practice it diligently.

When the mediocre hear of the Way, they doubt it.

When the foolish hear of the Way, they laugh out loud.

If it were not laughed at, it would not be the Way.

Therefore it is said,

"The enlightenment of the Way seems like dullness; progression in the Way seem like regression; the even path

When the intelligent man hears about Nature's alternating ways, he seeks to embody it within himself. The mediocre man sometimes accepts it and sometimes does not.

Unintelligent men scoff at it. Yet this very scoffing at intelligence itself exemplifies Nature's way of alternation.

This is the reason for the old sayings: Nature's brightest day fades into night. Nature's most luxuriant growth ages toward decay.

Nature's smoothest plain erodes itself away into rough —

When the most sincere hear about the road to self-knowledge,

They will devote themselves to bringing it into practice

When the fairly sincere hear about the road to self-knowledge

They will only get out of it what suits their purposes

When the hardened hear about the road to self-knowledge

They will roar with laughter

If they didn't roar, it would not be true

Therefore there are some aphorisms to it:

The road to light appears to be dark

Going forward sometimes feels like going back

The way to the

THE IDENTITY OF THE DIFFERENTIAL

The best students, learning of the Tao, set to work earnestly to practice

the Way. Mediocre students now cherish it, now let it go.

The worst students mock at it. Were it not thus mocked, it were unworthy to be Tao.

Thus spake the makers of Saws: the Tao at its brightest is obscure. Who

When a thoughtful man hears of the Tao, he tries to follow it.

When an average man hears of the Tao,

he wonders about it, but then tends to forget it.

When a fool hears of the Tao, he makes fun of it.

If someone didn't make fun of it, it wouldn't be the Tao.

Therefore, when seeking the Tao,

light

of the Way seems to go up and down."

Great power appears like a valley.

Great purity appears tarnished.

Great character appears insufficient.

Solid character appears weak.

True integrity appears changeable.

Great space has no corners.

Great ability takes time to mature.

Great music has the subtlest sound.

Great form has no shape.

The Way is hidden and indescribable.

Yet the Way alone is adept

terrain.

Nature's most harmonious adjustment generates conflict. Nature's most beautiful objects grow dim and ugly. Nature's greatest prize soon becomes despised. Nature's strongest power eventually weakens. Nature's soundest supports gradually rot away. Nature's squarest corners soon become rounded. Nature's grandest structures sooner or later are destroyed. Nature's loudest sounds are finally silenced.

simple road is a hard way to take

But also:

The greatest personality turns out to be vain

The purest white turns out to be grey

The most righteous proves to be unfair

Kindness seems but a thin layer

With the truth one can go in all directions

Like a square circle

Like an inexhaustible barrel

Like singing without words

Like a sculpture with no shadow

In that way the road is hidden and not captured in words

Only the road to self-knowledge has a beginning and an end

advanceth in that Way, retireth. Its smooth Way is rough. Its summit is a valley. Its beauty is ugliness. Its wealth is poverty. Its virtue, vice. Its stability is change. Its form is without form. Its fullness

is vacancy. Its utterance is silence. Its reality is illusion.

Nameless and imperceptible is the Tao; but it informeth and perfecteth all things.

seems dark,

advancing feels like retreating,

the simple appears difficult,

power is like weakness,

purity seems tarnished,

true virtue seems deficient and unsteady,

and the clear seems obscure.

The true square has no corners.

The true vessel never sails.

The true sound is hard to hear.

The true form has no shape.

The Tao is hidden, beyond definition; but it alone fulfills.

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All Things
The Way produced
the One;
the One produced
two;
two produced three;
and three produced
all things.
All things have the
receptivity of the
female
and the activity of the
male.
Through union with
the life force they
blend in harmony.
People

Nature first begets
one thing. The one
thing begets another.
The two produce a
third. In this way, all
things are begotten.
Why? Because all
things are
impregnated by two
alternating
tendencies, the
tendency towards
completion and the
tendency towards
initiation, which
acting together,
complement each
other.
Most men dislike to
be considered of no
account, lowly,
unworthy.

The unspeakable
gives birth to one
One to a second
And out of the
second arises the
third
The third brings the
whole creation to life
Everything is carried
by the dark and
comes to light
The breath of
Emptiness creates
order
People hate to be
alone, unimportant
and

THE VEILS OF
THE TAO
The Tao formulated
the One. The One
exhaled the Two.
The Two were
parents of the Three.
The Three were
parents of all things.
All things pass from
Obscurity to
Manifestation,
inspired
harmoniously by
the Breath of the
Void.
Men do not like

Out of Tao, One.
Out of One, Two.
Out of Two, Three.
Out of Three, all
things.
All things carry Yin
and face Yang.
Out of the union of
Yin and Yang,
harmony.
No one wants to

hate being orphaned,
lonely, and
unworthy.
Yet kings and nobles
call themselves such.
Often gain can be a
loss, and loss can be
a gain.
What others teach, I
teach also:
"The violent die a
violent death."
I shall make this
primary in my
teaching.

Yet intelligent
leaders call
themselves thus.
For people are
admired for their
humility and
despised for their
pride.
There are many other
ways of illustrating
what I am teaching:
"Extremists reach
untimely ends." This
saying may be taken
as a good example.

useless
And yet that is what a
true man takes
pleasure in
One who becomes
smaller, becomes
bigger
One who becomes
bigger, becomes
smaller
I only tell what
everybody already
knows:
One who lives in a
complicated way,
dies in a complicated
way
That is what it's all
about

to be fatherless,
virtueless, unworthy:
yet rulers
describe themselves
by these names. Thus
increase bringeth
decrease to
some, and decrease
bringeth increase to
others.
Others have taught
thus; I consent to it.
Violent men and
strong die not
by natural death. This
fact is the foundation
of my law.

be "orphaned," " "
widowed," or
"unworthy."
But kings and princes
use these words as
titles for themselves.
You win by losing.
You lose by winning.
It has been said, and I
agree, "A violent
man dies violently."

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The Value of Non-action

The softest things in the world overcome the hardest.

Non-being penetrates even where there is no space.

That which is most yielding eventually overcomes what is most resistant. That which is not becomes that which is.

The softest is stronger than the very hardest

That which makes everything be what it is, penetrates everything

Therefore I know that it's wise to leave and

THE COSMIC METHOD

The softest substance hunteth down the hardest; the unsubstantial penetrateth where there is no opening.

The softest thing overcomes the hardest thing.

That which has no substance can enter where there is

Through this I know the value of non-action.

Teaching without words and the value of non-action are understood by few in the world.

Acting without coercing or being coerced is best.

Guiding by example rather than by words is most successful. Such simple truths are so hard to understand.

not do anything

That one doesn't need lessons for it

That of all doings, leaving is where true happiness lies

In this world only a few understand this

Here is the Virtue of Inertia.

Few are they who attain: whose speech is Silence, whose Work is Inertia.

no space.

This shows the value of non-ado.

Teaching without words; doing without ado: hard to accomplish.

.

How to Endure

Fame or your life,
which do you love
more?

Life or material
wealth, which is
more valuable?

Loss or gain, which
is worse?

Therefore those who

Esteem by others or
self-esteem, which is
better? To value
things or to value
yourself, which is
better? To have more
or to have less, which
is worse?

The more you have,
the more you have to
lose.

What comes first, life
or status?

What's more
important to you,
yourself or your
possessions?

What's worse, having
or losing?

One who wants a lot
pays a high price

One who has a lot,
has

MONITORIAL

What shall it profit a
man if he gain fame
or wealth, and lose
his life?

If a man cling to
fame or

Fame or self: which
matters more?

Self or possessions:
which is more
valuable?

Loss or gain: which
is worse?

Attachment to things
brings suffering.

desire most spend
most.

Those who hoard
most lose most.

Those who are
contented are not
disappointed.

Those who know
when to stop prevent
danger.

Thus they can long
endure.

The more you value
things, the less you
value your self. The
more you depend on
others for esteem, the
less you are
self-sufficient.

He who knows how
to discriminate
wisely avoids danger,
And continues safely
on his way.

a lot to lose

But one who is
satisfied knows
neither fear nor
disgrace

And one who has
stopped playing a
part in the game will
never be afraid again
and will live happily
ever after

wealth, he risketh
what is worth more.

Be content, not
fearing disgrace. Act
not, and risk not
criticism. Thus

live thou long,
without alarm.

Much hoarded, much
to be lost.

Know when enough
is enough. Avoid
disgrace.

Know when to stop.
Avoid danger.

This is how to
endure.

Skill Seems Awkward
The greatest perfection seems incomplete,
but its utility is never impaired.
The greatest fullness seems empty,
but its use cannot be exhausted.
What is most

What is most complete is still incomplete: Yet it is as complete as it can be. That which has achieved the most, still has the whole of its future yet to be achieved: Hence it will not stop achieving.
Make a thing as straight as possible; Yet it is still crooked or will become crooked.

Perfection seems unfinished to this world
But it never perishes
Fullness is empty to the world
But it's inexhaustible
That which is correct, is incorrect to the world

THE OVERFLOWING OF THE
Despise thy masterpieces; thus renew the vigor of thy creation.
Deem thy fullness emptiness; thus shall thy fullness never be empty.
Let the straight appear crooked

The perfect seems flawed, but its usefulness is unlimited.
Full seems empty, but it is inexhaustible.
Straight seems bent.
Intelligent seems

direct seems devious.
The greatest skill seems awkward.
The greatest eloquence seems like stuttering.
Movement overcomes cold.
Stillness overcomes heat.
The serene and calm are guides for all.

Acquire the greatest skill; And there will still be endless skill to be acquired.
Develop the greatest power of expression; And there will be much that is unexpressed and inexpressible.
The same may be said about activity and passivity and cold and heat. Only he who fully accepts these alternations is the best guide for all to follow.

Wisdom seems foolish to the world
Telling the truth a disgrace
Like movement chases away coldness
And rest cools down
Purity and calmness show one the right direction

to thee, thy Craft clumsiness; thy Musick discord.
Exercise moderateth cold; stillness heat.
To be pure and to keep silence, is the True Law of all that are beneath Heaven.

stupid.
Eloquent seems tongue-tied.
Motion defeats the cold.
Stillness defeats the heat.
The Tao—Master remains calm as a guide for all things.

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Contentment
When the world lives
in accord with the
Way,
horses work on
farms.
When the world does
not live in accord
with the Way,
the cavalry

When what is natural
prevails in human
affairs, horses forced
to train for racing are
returned to the fertile
pastures. When
artificiality prevails
in human affairs,
horses are trained for
war and are restricted
to walled enclosures.
There is no greater
evil than desiring to
change others - (to
take from or give to
others what they do
not, of their own
accord, want to give
or take).

If men lived by their
nature
Horses would gallop
in the open air
But since men got
civilized
Battle horses
standing at the
frontier
There is no bigger

THE
WITHDRAWAL
FROM AMBITION
When the Tao
beareth away on
Earth, men put swift
horses to night-carts.
When it is neglected,
they breed chargers
in the

When the kingdom is
in harmony with the
Tao,
the horses haul
manure.
When the kingdom
departs from the Tao,
war-horses are bred
in the land.

practices in the parks.
The greatest
temptation to crime
is desire.
The greatest curse is
discontent.
The greatest calamity
is greed.
Whoever is content
with contentment is
always content.

There is no greater
misfortune than
desiring to change
oneself - being
discontented with
one's lot. There is no
greater vice than
desiring to change
things - (to possess,
control, or
reconstruct their
natures).
Only he who is
satisfied with
whatever
satisfactions his own
nature provides for
him is truly satisfied.

curse than
dissatisfaction
Nothing more
disastrous than being
discontent with life
Nothing more fatal
than being eager for
possessions
One who knows the
peace of satisfaction,
is always satisfied

border marches.
There is no evil
worse than ambition;
no misery worse than
discontent; no
crime greater than
greed. Content of
mind is peace and
satisfaction
eternal.

There is no greater
curse than wanting
more than enough.
There is no greater
sin than greed.
He who knows when
enough is enough
always has enough.

.
Understanding
One can know the world without going outside.
One can see the Way of heaven
without looking out the window.

Without going out-of-doors, one can know all he needs to know. Without even looking out of his window, one can grasp the nature of everything.

Without leaving my house, I understand the whole world
Without looking outside, I see the perfect order
The more you know,

THE VISION OF THE DISTANT
One need not pass his threshold to comprehend all that is under Heaven,
nor to look out from his lattice to behold the Tao Celestial.
Nay!

You can know the whole world without going out the door,
You can know the Way of Heaven without looking out the

The further one goes the less one knows.
Therefore the wise know without going about,
understand without seeing,
and accomplish without acting.

Without going beyond his own nature, one can achieve ultimate wisdom.
Therefore the intelligent man knows all he needs to know without going away, And he sees all he needs to see without looking elsewhere, And does all he needs to do without undue exertion.

the less you'll understand
One who is wise doesn't need to travel
He understands without looking
Does nothing but achieves everything

but
the farther a man goeth, the less he knoweth.
The sages acquired their knowledge without travel; they named all things
aright without beholding them; and, acting without aim, fulfilled their Wills.

window.
The further afield you go, the less you know.
The Tao—Master knows without going out;
understands without looking;
achieves without ado.

.

Doing Less

The pursuit of learning is to increase day by day.

The practice of the Way is to decrease day by day.

Less and less

While day by day the overzealous student stores up facts for future use, He who has learned to trust nature finds need for ever fewer external directions.

He will discard formula after formula, until he reaches the conclusion: Let Nature take its course.

Gathering knowledge makes life more complicated each time one gathers

Gathering wisdom makes life easier each time one gathers

Each time, more and more simple until simplicity is reached

Just by leaving, one man can

OBLIVION
OVERCOMING
KNOWLEDGE

The scholar seeketh daily increase of knowing; the sage of Tao daily decrease of doing.

He decreaseth it, again and again, until he doth no act with the lust

Pursue learning, gain daily.

Follow the Tao, lose daily.

By losing day-by-day, you arrive at non-ado.

Nothing done, nothing left

is done until one reaches non-action.

When nothing is done, nothing is left undone.

The world is led by not interfering.

Those who interfere cannot lead the world.

By letting each thing act in accordance with its own nature, everything that needs to be done gets done.

The best way to manage anything is by making use of its own nature; For a thing cannot function properly when its own nature has been disrupted.

achieve everything

One who wants nothing anymore, doesn't feel the need to do a thing, has conquered oneself

One who wants a lot has to do a lot and is as a slave to oneself

of

result. Having attained this Inertia all accomplisheth itself.

He who attracteth to himself all that is under Heaven doth so without effort. He who maketh effort is not able to attract it.

undone.

Master the world by letting things be, by letting them take their own course.

The world can't be conquered.

The Power of Goodness

The wise have no mind-set.

They regard the people's minds as their own.

They are good to people who are good.

They are also good to people who are not good.

This is the power of goodness.

They are honest

The intelligent man is not willful. He accepts what others will for themselves as his will for them.

Those who appear as good, he accepts, And those who appear as bad, he accepts; For Nature accepts both.

Those who appear faithful, he accepts, And those

A wise man has no opinion at all

Therefore he can easily put himself in someone else's position

He accepts everybody and everything for what it is

In spite of any behaviour

He trusts the honest and the unfair

And naturally they become

THE ADAPTABILITY OF THE THE

The wise man hath no fixed principle; he adapteth his mind to his environment.

To the good I am good, and to the evil I am good also; thus all become good.

The Tao—Master does not have his heart set on anything in particular.

He wants to understand the hearts of the people.

He is good to people who are good.

He is also good to people who aren't good.

This is true goodness.

to those who are honest.

They are also honest to those who are dishonest.

This is the power of honesty.

The wise live in the world peacefully and harmoniously.

The people share a common heart, and the wise treat them as their own children.

who appear unfaithful, he accepts; For Nature accepts both.

The intelligent man treats every kind of nature impartially, And will good to one as much as the another. All people admire the intelligent man, Because he regards them all as a mother regards her children.

fair-minded

He trusts the reliable and the unreliable

And naturally all will become reliable

A wise man feels one with all people

They are all just as precious to him

They look and listen to him

And all are as children to him

To the true I am true, and to the false I am true; thus all become true.

The sage appeareth hesitating to the world, because his mind is detached.

Therefore the people look and listen to him, as his children; and thus doth he shepherd them.

He trusts people who are trustworthy.

He also trusts people who aren't trustworthy.

This is true trust.

The Tao—Master radiates peace and harmony.

Through him, the hearts of the people are made one.

Are the people his children, or is he their child?

Those Who Preserve Life

Coming into life and going out at death, the organs of life are thirteen;

the organs of death are thirteen;

and these thirteen make life vulnerable to death.

Why is this so?

Because they feed life too grossly.

It is said that those who preserve life walk the earth without fearing tigers and wild buffalo, and in

It is natural for man to be born and to die. And it is natural for each of his parts to be born and to die and to evolve through its life cycle.

Why do men become so perturbed and anxious to prolong the life of each part when endangered? The truth is that whatever is natural is good.

Humans come and go

Their bodies as the seat of life

Their bodies as the seat of death

Humans get old and decay

Why is that?

It's because they are already dead, but think that they're living

There have been stories told and written about people who had found true life

And

THE ESTIMATION OF LIFE

Man cometh into life, and returneth again into death.

Three men in ten conserve life; three men in ten pursue death.

Three men also in ten desire to live, but their acts hasten their journey

to the house of death. Why is this? Because of their efforts to preserve life.

But this I have heard.

Come into life, go into death.

Three out of ten have a lust for life.

Three out of ten have a lust for death.

Three out of ten just pass from birth to death

without appreciating either life or death.

Why is this?

Because none of them appreciates both life and death.

But there are those

battle they are not touched by weapons of war.

The wild buffalo's horns find nothing to gore;

the tiger's claws find nothing to tear;

and weapons' points find nothing to pierce.

Why is this so?

Because they have nothing for death to enter.

(Note: The thirteen organs of life may refer to the nine openings in the body and the four limbs.)

Since it is natural for man to dies anyway, being assisted by horn or claw or spear in bringing about his death in no way endangers his nature.

No wild buffalo horn can change the course of Nature. No tiger's claw can act unnaturally. No soldier's spear can go against Nature. Why? Because death is natural, but Nature cannot die.

wandered around the earth

Not afraid of tigers or rhinos

Those who avoided weapons and violence

And lived in harmony with all creatures

Therefore no creature felt threatened by them

And no weapon could harm them

Why is that?

Because they were only living

And that's where there is no room for death

He that is wise in the economy of his life, whereof he is warden for a season, journeyeth with no need to avoid the tiger or the rhinoceros, and goeth uncorseted among the warriors with no fear of sword or lance. The rhinoceros findeth in him no place vulnerable to its horn, the tiger to its claws, the weapon to its point. Why is this? Because there is no house of death in his whole body. {56}

[one out of ten?]

who appreciate both life and death.

When they travel the country, they are not attacked by rhinos and tigers.

When they go into battle, they are not wounded.

The rhino finds nothing to gore.

The tiger finds nothing to claw.

Weapons find nothing to pierce.

Why? Because such people have gone beyond death.

. Mystical Power The Way produces all things. Power nourishes them. Matter gives them physical form. Environment shapes their abilities. Therefore all things respect the Way and honor power. The Way is respected, and power is honored without anyone's order and always naturally. Therefore the	Nature produces things, and intelligence guides them. Although different in kind, each thing has its own self-sufficient intelligence to guide it. Nothing can fail to emulate Nature and intelligence by embodying them within its own life. Such emulation is not demanded, but occurs of its own accord. Nature	The Unspeakable makes all things appear The active force determines their nature Their nature determines their shape The circumstance determines their final appearance Therefore all creatures, With the exception of erring mankind, honour the Unspeakable And live according to their natures This is all a natural process	THE TEH AS THE NURSE All things proceed from the Tao, and are sustained by its forth-flowing virtue. Every one taketh form according to his nature, and is perfect, each in his particular Way. Therefore, each and every one of them glorify the Tao, and worship its forth-flowing Virtue. This glorifying of the Tao, this worship of the Teh, is constantly spontaneous, and	Tao gives birth to the ten thousand things. Te nurtures them. They are formed from matter and completed by environment. Therefore, the ten thousand things honor Tao and respect Te, not in response to commandments, but just naturally. Tao gives birth
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Way produces all things, and power nourishes them, caring for them and developing them, sheltering them and comforting them, nurturing them and protecting them, producing them but not possessing them, helping them but not obligating them, guiding them but not controlling them. This is mystical power.	originates and suckles, rears and develops, protects and provides for, and guides and perfects all things. Whatever is produced, Nature accepts it for what it is. However it behaves, Nature lets it follow its own way. Whatever its fortune, Nature injects no external interference. Such is Nature's marvelous sagacity.	nobody rewards them for it The Unspeakable makes them live, feeds them, makes them grow Fulfils them, gives them peace, supports and guards them It makes them live, but never forces them It takes them along the stream of life, but does not possess It makes mature, but does not control That is an unfathomable mystery	not by appointment of Law. Thus the Tao buddeth them out, nurtureth them, developeth them, sustaineth them, perfecteth them, ripeneth them, upholdeth them, and reabsorbeth them. It buddeth them forth, and claimeth not lordship over them; it is overseer of their changes, and boasteth not of his puissance; perfecteth them, and interfereth not with their Ways; this is called the Mystery of	to the ten thousand things, and Te nurtures, rears, develops, shelters, and protects them. But Tao and Te do not try to own or rule the ten thousand things, nor do they seek to make them dependent. This is true power.
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Practicing the Eternal
The beginning of the universe is the mother of all things.
Those who discover the mother understand the children.
Understanding the children and returning to the mother,
they live always free from harm.
Close the mouth, shut the doors,
and all of

Nature, because it has mothered all, may be regarded as Mother Nature.
He who understands Mother Nature, understands her children. But to avoid the children's mistakes, one should follow close to Mother Nature herself, If throughout his life he desires a safe guide.
If one remains silent and keeps to himself, he will not fail to

The world sprouts from something
People could call it the mother of the world
When one knows that mother, one knows her child
One who becomes like that child again, will know the mother
And for the rest of his life nothing can harm him ever again
He won't criticize anyone and lets no one influence him
And his life will be without worries
But one who

THE
WITHDRAWAL
INTO THE
SILENCE
The Tao buddeth forth all things under Heaven; it is the Mother of all.
Knowing the Mother, we may know her offspring. He that knoweth his
Mother, and abideth in Her nature, remaineth in surety all his days.
With the mouth closed, and the Gates of Breath controlled, he remaineth at ease all his days.

The world's Source, the Mother of all things.
Knowing the Mother, we know her children.
Knowing the children, but holding on to the Mother, we are free from the fear of death.
Stop talking, withdraw

life is without strain.
Open the mouth, meddle with affairs, and all of life is beyond help.
Seeing the small is insight;
to stay with the gentle is strength.
Use the Light, return to insight,
and thereby be preserved from harm.
This is practicing the eternal.

fulfill his life;
But is he gives advice and meddles in others' affairs, he invites trouble.
If you see what is small as it sees itself, And accept what is weak for what strength it has, and use what is dim for the light it gives, Then all will go well.
This is called acting naturally.

condemns others and whose interests concern only himself
Will be full of worries the rest of his life
One that sees a gleam of light in darkness sees the light at the end of the tunnel
Holding on to that gleam of light requires strength
One who follows that light, turns back to the original light
Then all danger is gone
And you'll live the eternal life

With the mouth open, and the Breath directed to
outward affairs, he hath no surety all his days.
To perceive that Minute Point is True Vision; to maintain the
Soft and Gentle is True Strength.
Employing harmoniously the Light Within so that it
returneth to its Origin, one guardeth even one's body from evil, and
keepeth Silence before all men.

from the rat-race, and life is full.
Blab on, lose yourself in busy-ness, and life is lost.
Seeing the small requires good vision.
Yielding is strength.
Turn to the Inner Light, and find the eternal.

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Leaders in Robbery
Those with even a scrap of sense
walk on the main way and fear only straying from the path.
The main way is smooth and easy,
but people like to be side-tracked.
While the courts are arrayed in splendor,

Let us be intelligent and follow Nature itself. Let us not stray.
Nature's way is simple and easy, but men prefer the intricate and artificial.
When they congregate in artistically engineered cities, and

When I possess True Knowledge
I will stroll on the right and simple road
I will avoid side paths
Because the straight road is easy to walk
But most people love the narrow side paths
The residences of the rich are neat and clean
But the

THE WITNESS OF GREED
Were I discovered by men, and charged with government, my first would be
lest I should become proud.
The true Path is level and smooth; but men love by-paths.
They adorn their courts, but they neglect their

If I had any sense, I would walk on the main road [the Tao],
and I would fear leaving it.
Keeping to the main road [the Tao] is so easy,
and yet people love to stray from it as they seek shortcuts.
Look!

the fields are full of weeds,
and the granaries are empty.
Yet some wear embroidered clothes, carry sharp swords, over-indulge themselves with food and drink,
and have more possessions than they can use.
They are leaders in robbery.
This is not the Way.

neglect their farms, their food supply is cut off.
When they bedeck themselves with ornaments and weapons, and display their fancy foods and rich properties, they thereby invite thievery. This is acting unnaturally.

fields of the poor are filled with weeds
And their granaries are empty
The elite wear generously-decorated and expensive clothes
Sharp swords hang on their waists
They stuff and they swill
They lose themselves in possession and wealth
They flaunt their stolen gear
Now, isn't that conscienceless?

fields, and leave their storehouses empty.
They wear elaborate and embroidered robes; they gird themselves with sharp swords; they eat and drink with luxury; they heap up goods; they are thievish and vainglorious. All this is opposite to the Way of Tao.

The royal palace is magnificent,
but the fields are full of weeds, and the granaries are empty.
Some are beautifully dressed and bejeweled,
wearing flashy weapons on their belts,
eating and drinking until they burst.
These people—these state-sanctioned crooks—
have far more than they need.
Surely, this isn't the Tao!

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Power

What is well established cannot be uprooted.

What is firmly held cannot slip away.

The power of sacrifice continues on from generation to generation.

Cultivated in the person, power becomes real.

Cultivated in the family, power becomes abundant.

Cultivated in the community, power endures.

Cultivated in the

What is deeply rooted in Nature cannot be uprooted. He who embraces Nature's way as his own will not easily go astray; And his children and grandchildren will continue to emulate him.

If one embodies Nature's way in his own life, he will be genuinely intelligent. If he establishes it in his family, his home life will be felicitous. If he cultivates it in he community, his future will be prosperous.

One who is rooted in this unfair world,

Won't be easy to unsettle

One who holds on to that world, can't let go

Therefore their children will suffer until the third and fourth generation

But one who follows his conscience

Will lead an impeccable life

One who takes care that his fellow men follow their conscience,

Makes them flourish

One who takes care that his neighbours follow their conscience,

Makes them examples

THE WITNESS OF WISDOM

If a man plant according to the Tao it will never be uprooted; if he thus gather, it will never be lost. His sons and his son's sons, one following another, shall honour the shrine of their ancestor.

The Tao, applied to oneself, strengtheneth the Body, to the family, bringeth wealth; to

Kapitel nicht vorhanden

nation, power flourishes.

Cultivated in the world, power becomes universal.

Therefore see the person as a person, the family as a family, the community as a community,

the nation as a nation, and the world as universal.

How do I know that the world is like this?

By this.

If he fosters it in his state, his future will be auspicious. If he inspires in in the whole country, his benefit will become universal. Thus one's own individual life serves as an example for other individuals.

One's family life serves as an example for other individuals. One's family life serves as a model for other families. One's community serves as a standard for other communities. One's state serves as an ideal for other states.

How do I know all this? It is obvious.

for everybody else

And when all of mankind follows its conscience,

There shall be a paradise on earth

Look at yourself if you want to understand yourself

Discover the connections and patterns in the way your nearest relations,

Cities and the nations, get on with each other

Because what's on a small scale, is on a big scale, too

How do I know it is that way?

Because I've done this myself

the district, prosperity; to

the state, great fortune. Let it be the Law of the Kingdom, and

all men will increase in virtue.

Thus we observe its effect in every case, as to the person, the family,

the district, the state, and the kingdom.

How do I know that this is thus universal under Heaven?

By experience.

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Know Harmony

Those filled with power
are like new-born
children.

Poisonous insects will
not sting them;
ferocious beasts will
not pounce upon them;
predatory birds will not
swoop down on them.

Their bones are pliable,
their muscles tender,
but their grip is firm.

They have never
known the union of
man and woman,
but the organ is fully
formed,
meaning that the vital
essence is strong.

They may cry

He who is intelligent
is like a little child.
Poisonous insects do
not sting him.
Ferocious beasts do
not attack him. Wild
birds do not claw
him. His bones are
soft, his muscles
weak, yet is grip is
strong.

Because he has no
urge for sexual
union, he is fully
satisfied. His vitality
is intact.

He can cry all day
without getting
hoarse.

A true human being is
like a new-born baby

Wasps and scorpions
won't sting it, snakes
and adders won't bite
it

Raptors and wild
animals won't attack it

Its bones and muscles
are soft and flexible,
yet it has a pretty tight
grip

Sex and libido are
strange to it, but its
little penis already is
able to stiffen

That is because its
nature is not yet
disturbed by

thou —

gh —

t —

THE SPELL OF THE
MYSTERY

He that hath the
Magick powers of the
Tao is like a young
child.

Insects will not sting
him or beasts or birds
of prey attack him.

The young child's
bones are tender and
its sinews are elastic,
but its

grasp is firm. It
knoweth nothing of
the Union of Man and
Woman, yet its

Organ may be excited.
This is because of its
natural perfection. It
will

Kapitel nicht
vorhanden

all day without getting
hoarse,
meaning that the
harmony is perfect.

To know harmony is to
be in accord with the
eternal.

To know the eternal is
to be enlightened.

To try to force life is
ominous.

To force the vital
essence with the mind
is violence.

The prime is past, and
decay follows,
meaning that it is
contrary to the Way.

Whatever is contrary to
the Way will soon
perish.

His existence is
harmonious. To
know such harmony
is to be in accord
with Nature.

To be in accord with
Nature is to be
achieving the goal of
life. But to seek
excitement is to
invite calamity.

Those too eager for
activity soon become
fatigued.

For when things
exhaust their vigour,
they age quickly.
Such impatience is
against Nature. What
is against Nature dies
young.

It can yell all day
without getting a
hoarse throat

Because everything is
still perfectly in
balance

Experiencing that
balance is called
"living in the eternal
present"

Living without past or
future is called "being
wise"

Every attempt to
extend life is pointless

One who wants to
control his life,
restrains oneself

It is unnatural that
things wither

That which is
unnatural will come to
an early end

cry all day long
without becoming
hoarse, because of the
harmony of its
being.

He who understandeth
this harmony knoweth
the mystery of the
Tao, and

becometh a True
Sage. All devices for
inflaming life, and
increasing the

vital Breath, by
mental effort are evil
and

factitious.

Things become
strong, then age. This
is in discord with the
Tao, and

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available

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Mystical Unity
Those who know do not speak.
Those who speak do not know.
Close the mouth;
shut the doors.
Smooth the sharpness; untie the tangles.
Dim the glare; calm the

He who is wise keeps silent. He who advises is a fool.
The wise man shuts his mouth, Closes his doors, Curbs his anxieties, Withdraws from entanglements, Remains untempted by attractions, And retains his self-sufficiency.
Nature is profoundly impartial.

Those who have experienced the Mystery don't speak about it
Those who do speak about it have not experienced the Mystery
Don't try to speak about the Unspeakable
That which cannot be seen, heard, felt or tasted
The shapes fade
The edges

THE EXCELLENCE OF THE MYSTERY
Who knoweth the Tao keepeth Silence; he who babbleth knoweth it not.
Who knoweth it closeth his mouth and controlleth the Gates of his Breath.
He will make his sharpness blunt; he will loosen his complexes; he will tone down his brightness to the general obscurity.

Those who know do not tell. Those who tell do not know.
Stop talking, withdraw from the rat-race, calm your spirit,
untangle yourself, soften your glare.
Be one with the dust

turmoil.
This is mystical unity.
Those achieving it are detached from friends and enemies, from benefit and harm, from honor and disgrace.
Therefore they are the most valuable people in the world.

It cannot be persuaded by pampering, Nor dissuaded by scoffing. It cannot be tempted by bribes, Nor influenced by injury. It cannot be cajoled by flattery, Nor chagrined by slander. Thus it is the most reliable thing in the world.

weaken
Confusion disappears
The light brightens
The unrest is extinguished
That's what they call a "Mystical Experience"
Neither affection nor hate can move him
Profit nor loss will touch him
Honour nor disgrace will harm him
Therefore he is the world's noblest man

This is called the Secret of Harmony.
He cannot be insulted either by familiarity or aversion; he is immune to ideas of gain or loss, of honour or disgrace; he is the true man, unequalled under Heaven.

of the earth.
This is primal union.
Achieving union with the Tao places one beyond attraction and repulsion, benefit and harm, honor and disgrace.
This is the highest state of being.

. Love Peace States are governed by justice. Wars are waged by violations. The world is mastered by nonintervention. How do I know this? By this: The more restrictions there are, the poorer the people. The more sharp weapons, the more trouble in the state. The more	A good leader guides by example; A bad leader resorts to force and intrigue. Everything gains by noninterference. How do I know this? Consider the evidence: The more restrictions and taxes there are, the poorer the people become. The more weapons people possess, the more they fight. The more complicated machines become, the greater the danger from mechanical accident. The more laws are enacted and taxes assessed, the greater the number of law-breakers and —	With laws men rule a state With ruses people make war Without laws and without ruses you'll have a peaceful mankind How do I know this? Well, because of the following: The more orders and prescriptions, the more defiant the people become The more arming, the bigger the chaos The more knowledge and science, the more machines and	THE TRUE INFLUENCE One may govern a state by restriction; weapons may be used with skill and cunning; but one acquireth true command only by freedom, given and taken. How am I aware of this? By experience that to multiply restrictive laws in the kingdom impoverisheth the people; the use of machines causeth disorder in state and race alike. The more men use skill and cunning,	In governing, employ no surprises. In waging war, employ only surprises. Win the world with non-ado. How do I know this? Like this! The more rules and regulations there are, the poorer the people become. The more experts there are, the more confusion there is. The more skillful and clever technicians there are, the more horrifying
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clever cunning, the more contrivances. The more rules and regulations, the more thieves and robbers. Therefore the wise say, "Do not interfere, and people transform themselves. Love peace, and people do what is right. Do not intervene, and people prosper. Have no desires, and people live simply."	tax-evaders. This is why the intelligent man concludes: When I attend to my own business, other people are able to attend to theirs. When I exemplify self-reliance, other people will devote themselves to the exercise of their own intelligence. When I make no demands upon them, other people themselves will prosper. When I express no desire to interfere in their lives, others will become genuinely self-sufficient.	artificiality The more rules and decisions, the more thieves and robbers Therefore a wise man says: I don't do anything, and the people change spontaneously I take rest, and the people become honest spontaneously I don't make an issue of anything, and the people find wealth inside themselves I don't want anything, and the people return to simplicity	machines there are; and the more laws there are, the more felons there are. A wise man has said this: I will refrain from doing, and the people will act rightly of their own accord; I will love Silence, and the people will instinctively turn to perfection; I will take no measures, and the people will enjoy true wealth; I will restrain ambition, and the people will attain simplicity.	inventions are produced. The more "law and order" there is, the higher the crime-rate. Therefore, the Tao-Master says, I do nothing, and the people govern themselves. I practice keeping quiet, and the people find justice. I seek emptiness, and the people prosper. I have no desires, and the people return to a natural and simple life.
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Results of Process
When the government is relaxed, people are happy.
When the government is strict, people are anxious.
Good fortune leans on bad fortune;
bad fortune hides behind good fortune.
Who knows the results of process?
Is

When government governs little, people are happy. When government governs much, people are miserable.
Thus happiness depends on little,
And misery depends on much.
What does the desire to govern come to?
To restrict interferers is itself interference.
So attempts to increase happiness end only in misery.

The fewer rules and laws there are, the happier mankind will be
The more rules and laws, the more there will be of dissatisfaction and conflicts
Someone's wealth comes at the expense of someone else's poverty
Misery for one

ADAPTATION TO ENVIRONMENT
The government that exerciseth the least care serveth the people best;
that which meddles with everybody's business worketh all manner of harm.
Sorrow and joy are bedfellows; who can divine the final result of either?
Shall we avoid restriction? Yea; restriction distorteth nature, so that
even what seemeth good in it is evil.

When the government is restrained,
the people are happy and satisfied.
When the government meddles in everything,
the people are disgruntled and miserable.
Happiness eclipses misery.
Misery eclipses happiness.
Which will it

there no justice?
When the just become unjust, goodness becomes evil.
People have been deluded for a long time.
Therefore the wise are square but not cornered,
sharp but not cutting, straight but not strained,
brilliant but not dazzling.

Mankind has been foolish for so long a time!
The intelligent man knows what is best, but does not make others conform. He knows directions, but does not direct. He pursues the straightest way to the goal, but does not urge others to deviate from their course. He is enlightened, but he cares not whether others see his light.

is the result of someone else's wealth
When will this ever stop?
One who is wise is righteous and won't play that game
He is just and fair and will never hurt anybody
He shines, but does not blind

For how long have men suffered from misunderstanding of this.
The wise man is foursquare, and avoideth aggression; his corners do not injure others. He moveth in a straight line and turneth not aside therefrom;
he is brilliant but doth not blind with his brightness.

be?
The straight becomes crooked.
Good becomes evil.
The people remain bewildered.
Thus, the Tao—Master is sharp but not cutting, incisive but not biting,
straight but not controlling, bright but not glaring.

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Be Frugal
In leading people and serving heaven it is best to be frugal.
Being frugal is to be prepared from the start.
Being prepared from the start is to build up power.
By building up power nothing is impossible.
If

In managing men or anything else, the intelligent man uses self-restraint. Only by self-restraint can one forestall trouble.
Forestalling trouble strengthens one's position. Such strengthened position enables one to withstand everything.

To get mankind to live in peace requires a full detachment
Because only one who is detached knows how to live truthfully
Letting go of everything before dying makes one live righteously
One who lives righteously knows no trouble
For one who knows no

WARDING THE TAO
.
To balance our earthly nature and cultivate our heavenly nature, tread the Middle Path.
This Middle Path alone leadeth to the Timely Return to the True Nature.
This Timely Return resulteth from the constant gathering of Magick Powers. With that Gathering cometh Control.

In governing the country and serving Heaven, show restraint.
Showing restraint is submission to the Tao.
Submission to the Tao will fill you with Te.
Being filled with Te, there will be no limit to your power, and there will be nothing you cannot overcome.
When there is nothing you cannot overcome,

nothing is impossible, then there are no limits.
Those without limits are capable of leading a country.
Those with maternal leadership can long endure.
This is to be deeply rooted in a firm foundation,
the way of long life and eternal vision.

Withstanding everything, one remains unchallenged.
Being unchallenged, one governs easily.
Because he embodies Mother Nature within himself, he retains a sound position.
This is the way to be deeply rooted and firmly based, And durable and long-lived.

trouble, life is unbounded
One who is unbounded, considers the world as his home
One who feels united with creation, lives happily ever after
Then you'll be rooted again and you'll stand firmly
Only like that will you live happily ever after and understand everything

This Control we know
to be without Limit and he who knoweth the Limitless may rule the state.
He who possesseth the Tao continueth long. He is like a plant with well-set roots and strong stems. Thus it secureth long continuance of its life.

you will be a true ruler indeed.
You will be one with the country.
You will be the Mother of the country.
Being the Mother of the country, you will have deep roots and a firm base.
Your reign will be long-lasting.
This is the Tao of long life and eternal vision.

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Spirits
Leading a large
country is like
cooking a small fish.
When the world is
led in accord with the
Way,
spirits lose their
powers.
It is not that they lose

Whether governing a
big country or
cooking a little fish,
follow Nature's way
and no evil
tendencies will get
control.
This does not mean
that the dangers of
evils

Making sure that
mankind lives in
peace is a trifle
Where righteousness
is the main guide,
delusions won't last
Not that there will be
no delusions at all
But the people will
be less

THE DUTY OF
GOVERNMENT
The government of a
kingdom is like the
cooking of fish.
If the kingdom be
ruled according to
the Tao, the spirits of
our
ancestors will not
manifest their Teh.

Rule a large country
as you would cook a
small fish.
Follow the Tao, and
evil will be subdued.
Evil will still be
there, but it

their powers,
but that their powers
no longer harm
people.
Not only do the
spirits not harm
people,
but the wise also do
not harm people.
Not harming each
other, spiritual power
grows.

can be eliminated
entirely, but only that
they will cease to
harm men.
When ordinary men
are unharmed, their
leaders are
unharmed.
And when nobody
harms anybody,
perfect harmony
prevails.

susceptible to them
Delusions damage
people, and a wise
man shows them it's
so
Therefore a wise man
is a threat to
delusion,
But no threat for
mankind
Therefore they will
become wise, too

These spirits have
this Teh, but
will not turn it
against men. It is
able to hurt men; so
also is the
Wise King; but he
doth not.
When these powers
are in accord, their
Good Will produceth
the Teh,
endowing the people
therewith.

won't be able to do
much harm.
The Tao—Master does
no harm.
If no harm is done,
then the power of the
Tao can flow on.

. Large and Small Countries A large country is like low land where rivers flow, a place where everything comes together, the female of all. The female overcomes the male with tranquillity. Tranquillity is underneath. A large country wins over a small country by placing itself below the small country.	To be great, a state must be passively receptive, like the ocean which accepts whatever the rivers bring into it, or like the feminine which always submits to the masculine. Recall how the female always overcomes the male by means of her passivity. Passivity is submissiveness. Thus the great state places itself at the service of a small state before before it absorbs the small state.	When mankind lives in peace, There will be no superiors and inferiors It is like a big river, In which all side currents have come to rest The wildness comes to rest in peacefulness, Because it is calm	THE MODESTY OF THE THE A state becometh powerful when it resembleth a great river, deep-seated; to it tend all the small streams under Heaven. It is as with the female, that conquereth the male by her Silence. Silence is a form of Gravity. Thus a great state attracteth small states by meeting their views,	A great country is like a sea into which all streams flow, the Female of the world. The Female overcomes the Male with stillness. The woman overcomes the man by lying underneath him. Therefore, a great country dominates a small country by submitting to it;
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a large country by placing itself below the large country. Thus some win by placing themselves below, and others win by being below. A large country wants to protect people, and a small country wants to join and serve. Thus both get what they want. It is best for the large country to place itself below.	And a small state must serve the interests of the great state before it can be taken into the great state. Hence, some submit in order to take, while others submit in order to be taken. When a great state desires to have more people, and a small state desires to be protected, it is by submission that both obtain what they desire.	and most lowly One who is the least by his disarming simplicity, Is therefore appealing to his fellow men And so it's a benefit for both of them So one who looks big, has to become small again	and small states attract the great state by revering its eminence. In the first case this Silence gaineth supporters; in the second, favour. The great state uniteth men and nurtureth them; the small state wisheth the good will of the great, and offereth service; thus each gaineth its advantage. But the great state must keep Silence.	and a small country can dominate a great country by submitting to it. Yield and conquer. A great country wants to unite and shelter people. A small country wants to come in and be sheltered. Each gets what it wants. Thus, the great country should yield.
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The Way is Valued
The Way is sacred to all things.
It is treasure for the good and sanctuary for the bad.
Fine words can buy honor.
Good deeds can gain respect.
Though there be bad people, why reject them?
Therefore at the crowning of the emperor
or at the installation of

Nature is profoundly worth while. It is that which is most worth while for good men, And it is the only real value for bad men.
Flattery may gain favours, and gifts may help one to advance, But bad men know how to flatter and bribe.
Therefore when leaders are installed in office, Better than he who artfully gives lavish

Everything inclines towards the original balance
It's the bliss of true men
It's a sanctuary for the untruthful
But people flaunt themselves with flattery
They only do nice things in exchange for gratitude
Everybody does that so why shouldn't you?
Therefore the people shout with joy when a new leader comes on the scene
And

THE WORKINGS OF THE TAO
The Tao is the most exalted of all things. It is the ornament of the good, and the protection and purification of the evil.
Its words are the fountain of honour, and its deeds the engine of achievement. It is present even in evil.
Though the Son of Heaven were enthroned with his three Dukes appointed to

The Tao is the source of all things,
the good man's treasure, the bad man's refuge.
You can buy beautiful words.
You can build your reputation with good deeds.
But even bad people can use beautiful words and perform good deeds.
So when the new emperor is crowned (and

the three ministers, instead of sending gifts of jade and a team of four horses, remain still and send the Way.
Why did the ancients prize this Way?
Did they not say, "Seek, and you will find;
let go, and you will be forgiven."
Therefore the Way is valued by the world.

gifts and glowing tribute, Is one who, by doing nothing but accepting his natural role as a follower, pays genuine homage.
Why have men always valued Nature? Was it not because Nature submitted humbly to the task of benefiting the good and the bad alike? Is this not the reason why it is the most worth while thing in the world?

let themselves be fooled by pomp and circumstance
It's wise not to participate in this
Do you know why the former wise people considered simplicity so important?
Because they experienced that, one who seeks will find
And that the truth sets one free from past and future
Therefore simplicity is most important in this life

as might
fill the hands, with a team of horses to follow, this gift were not to be
matched against the Tao, which might be offered by the humblest of men.
Why did they of old time set such store by the Tao? Because he that sought it might find it, and because it was the Purification from all evil. Therefore did all men under Heaven esteem it the most exalted of all things.

the three ministers of state are installed),
do not send gifts of jade and four-horse chariots.
Instead, be still, and offer the Tao.
The ancients treasured the Tao because, when you seek it, you find it; through the Tao, even sinners receive forgiveness.
That is why everybody loves the Tao.

. The Wise Never Strive Act without interfering. Work without doing. Taste the tasteless. Large or small, many or few, repay injury with goodness. Handle the difficult while it is still easy. Handle the big while it is still small. Difficult tasks begin with what	Act disinterestedly - without intending that your action shall change the course of Nature. Behave indifferently - without trying to impose your own ideas upon the lives of others. Appreciate natural flavours - without adulterating natural foods with artificial flavours. Accept the fact that what is small grows big, and what are few become many. Respond intelligently even to unintelligent treatment. Take care of what is difficult while it is still easy, and deal with what will become big while it is yet small; For all difficult things originate in what is	Act without intention Stop labouring Just enjoy life One who doesn't honour something small Isn't worthy of something big No more eye for an eye and tooth for a tooth Turn to them your other cheek Discover that what seems complicated is in fact very simple See the grandeur in what seems insignificant Don't turn simplicity into complexity Living purely is simple But people	FORETHOUGHT AT THE OUTSET Act without lust of result; work without anxiety; taste without attachment to flavour; esteem small things great and few things many; repel violence with gentleness. Do great things while they are yet small, hard things while they are yet easy; for all things, how great or hard soever, have	Act without ado; work without effort. Taste the tasteless; treat the small as large and the few as many. Reward evil with goodness. Take on the difficult while it is still easy, the large while it is still small. Difficult always begins as easy; large always
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is easy. Great accomplishments begin with what is small. Therefore the wise never strive for the great and thus achieve greatness. Rash promises inspire little trust. Taking things too lightly results in much difficulty. Thus the wise always confront difficulties and therefore have no difficulty.	easy. The most difficult things in the world Must be accomplished through the easiest. The greatest things in the world Must be accomplished through the smallest. Therefore the intelligent man, although never troubling himself with big things, still accomplishes the same result (by dealing with them when they are small) He who is careless about things when they are easy will have to face them when they become difficult.	have made it complicated So one who's wise will never make trouble And therefore he can move mountains One who promises a lot is hardly ever trustworthy One with a lot of blinkers on will bring to pass lots of troubles But one who is wise looks before he leaps Therefore he won't start at all And because of that he knows no trouble	a beginning when they are little and easy. So thus the wise man accomplisheth the greatest tasks without undertaking anything important. Who undertaketh thoughtlessly is certain to fail in attainment; who estimateth things easy findeth them hard. The wise man considereth even easy things hard, so that even hard things are easy to him.	begins as small. Therefore, the Tao–Master never tries to be great. As a result, he accomplishes great things. Big promises produce little trust. Treating something as quite easy makes it very difficult. The Tao–Master regards everything as difficult, which means that, for him, everything is easy.
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Chapter 64
Sanderson Beck

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Do Not Grab
What stays still is easy to hold.
Without omens it is easy to plan.
The brittle is easy to shatter.
The minute is easy to scatter.
Handle things before they appear.
Organize things before there is confusion.
A tree as big as a person's embrace grows from a tiny shoot.
A tower nine stories high begins with a mound of earth.
A journey of a thousand miles begins under one's feet.
To act is to fail.
To grab

Chapter 64
Archie J. Bahm

That which remains quiet is easy to handle. That which has not yet developed is easy to manage, That which is weak is easy to control. That which is still small is easy to direct.
Deal with little troubles before they become big. Attend to little problems before they get out of hand.
For the largest tree was once a sprout, The tallest tower started with a single brick, And the longest journey began with a first stem.
Just as he who tries to hasten what is natural, must fail in his attempt, So he who tries to retard what is natural, must fail

Chapter 64
Anonymous

Peace is easy to keep
What might happen is easy to prevent
That which is fragile is easy to break
What's still very small, can be chased away easily
A big tree starts with a small seed
A terrace-yard started with a mound of earth
A thousand-mile journey starts with a single step
One who disturbs the natural order, harms oneself
One who intervenes loses oneself
A wise man abstains far from this
Therefore —

Chapter 64
Aleister Crowley

ATTENDING TO DETAILS
It is easy to grasp what is not yet in motion, to withstand what is not yet manifest, to break what is not yet compact, to disperse what is not yet coherent. Act against things before they become visible; attend to order before disorder ariseth.
The tree which filleth the embrace grew from a small shoot; the tower nine-storied rose from a low foundation; the ten-day journey began with a single step.
He who acteth worketh harm; he who graspeth findeth it a slip.

Chapter 64
George Cronk

That which is lying still is easy to pick up.
That which has not yet happened is easy to prevent.
That which is brittle is easily shattered.
That which is small is easily scattered.
Deal with things before they become problems.
Straighten things out before they become confused.
A huge tree begins as a tiny sprout.
A terrace nine storeys high begins as a small pile of dirt.
The giant pine tree grows from a tiny sprout.
A thousand-mile journey begins with a

is to lose.
Therefore the wise do not act and do not fail.
They do not grab and do not lose.
In handling things people usually fail
when they are about to succeed.
Be as careful at the end as at the beginning,
and there will be no failure.
Therefore the wise desire to have no desires.
They do not value rare treasures.
They learn what is unknown,
returning to what many have missed
so that all things may be natural without interference.

in his attempt.
Since the intelligent man does not seek to accelerate, he does not make waste, And since he does not try to restrain, he does not fail. People are as likely to go wrong in not letting things come to their normal conclusions as they are in not letting them start in their own way.
The intelligent man has no desire to redirect and no desire for what is hard to get. He has learned to be unlearned, and returned to the way which learned men have forgotten. He lets each thing develop in its own way, without any attempt to intervene.

he won't hurt himself and
so he remains himself
But people break down everything and they call it "progress"
Once started, there is no end to
A wise man strives for what others don't
And takes to be important what others take to be unimportant
He unlearns what other are still learning
And turns back to a state of mind others have left
Then he knows the way back to the source
But realizes that the people do not want to hear about it

The wise
man acteth not, so worketh no harm; he doth not grasp, and so doth not let go. Men often ruin their affairs on the eve of success, because they are not as prudent at the end as in the beginning.
The wise man willeth what others do not will, and valueth not things rare. He learneth what others learn not, and gathered up what they despise.
Thus he is in accord with the natural course of events, and is not overbold
in action.

single step.
Intrude and ruin.
Grasp and lose.
Therefore, the Tao-Master practices non-ado and so does not ruin;
he is not grasping and so does not lose.
People often fail just when they are about to succeed.
Be as careful at the end as you are at the beginning, and you will not fail.
Therefore, the Tao-Master desires no-desire, treasures no treasures, studies no studies.
He pays attention to what others have ignored.
He helps all things find their center,

Know the Eternal Standard

The ancients who ruled skillfully did not try to enlighten people but kept them in the dark.

People are hard to lead when they are too clever.

Those who lead with cleverness rob the

Originally people knew how to follow Nature, For they did not try to arouse in the people an interest in cunning, but let them remained unspoiled.

The shrewder people are, the harder they are to govern. Therefore to try to improve government by means of increasing cleverness in people is to endanger it.

The former sages, who travelled along the straight and simple path

Brought the people wisdom instead of knowledge

When people know much, unity is impossible to keep

That's why science disturbs the togetherness of men

And wisdom guards

THE PURITY OF THE THE

They of old time that were skilled in the Tao sought not to enlighten the people, but to keep them simple.

The difficulty of government is the vain knowledge of the people. To use cleverness in government is to scourge the kingdom; to use

The ancient rulers who followed the Tao

did not try to enlighten the people, but rather aimed at making them dull.

People are hard to govern because they are so clever.

Rulers who seek to enlighten the people are like bandits who prey

country.

Those who lead without cleverness bless the country.

Understanding these two is to know the eternal standard.

Knowing the eternal standard is mystical power.

Mystical power is deep and far-reaching, leading all things to return to perfect harmony.

But to improve government by encouraging honesty in the people is beneficial.

The comprehend the significance of these two ways is to be profoundly intelligent.

Profound intelligence is that penetrating and pervading power To restore all things to their original harmony.

that togetherness

One who understands this

Understands that wisdom and knowledge are in conflict with each other

Once you understand this, you'll be wise

And you will turn back to simplicity

And feel one with everything and everybody

simplicity is to anoint it.

Know these things, and make them thy law and thine example. To possess this Law is the Secret Perfection of rule. Profound and Extended is this Perfection; he that possesseth it is indeed contrary to the rest, but he attracteth them to full accordance.

upon the land.

Rulers who forget about enlightening the people are a real blessing to the nation.

Remember these two enduring principles: they represent the power [Te] of the Tao.

Te goes deep and far. All things turn back and reach original harmony.

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Leading from Behind
Great rivers and seas
are lords of all
mountain streams,
because they are
good at staying
below them.
Therefore they are
lords of the streams.
Thus the wise in
watching over the
people
speak humbly from
below the people,
and in leading

Rivers and seas
dominate the
landscape, Because,
by being good at
seeking the lowest
places, they fill and
occupy and spread
over everything.
Likewise the
intelligent man is
superior to others,
Because he admits
that he is inferior,
And he is a leader of
others Because he is
willing to be

Why are the seas and
rivers the biggest
among all waters?
Because they are
located on the lowest
places
Therefore they are
the biggest
So one who is wise
among fools must be
the least

PUTTING ONE'S
SELF LAST
The oceans and the
rivers attract the
streams by their skill
in being
lower than they; thus
are they masters
thereof. So the Wise
Man, to be
above men, speaketh
lowly; and to precede
them acteth with
humility.
Thus, though he

Great rivers and seas
are kings to hundreds
of lesser streams
because they lie
lower than the lesser
streams.
To stand above, you
must speak from
below.
To lead, you must
follow behind.
This is how the ruler

the people get behind
them.
In this way the wise
watch over the
people
but do not oppress
them;
they lead the people
but do not block
them.
Thus everyone
happily goes along
without getting tired.
Because they do not
compete,
the world cannot
compete with them.

a follower.
Thus although he is
actually superior to
others, they do not
feel depressed. And
when he leads them,
they do not feel that
they are being forced
to obey. So all are
happy to give him
their support.
Since he competes
with no one, no one
competes with him.

And therefore he is
the greatest
But fools won't
consider him as a
threat
They just don't
understand him and
take no notice of him
Because he doesn't
fight and argue with
anybody, he is
indisputable

be above them, they
feel no burden; nor,
though he
precede them, do
they feel insulted.
So then do all men
delight to honour
him, and grow not
weary of him. He
contendeth not
against any man;
therefore no man is
able to contend
against him.

who follows the Tao
stands above and
leads the people.
And in this way,
the people are neither
overburdened nor
oppressed.
The whole nation
supports such a ruler.
He contends with no
one, and no one
contends with him.

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Three Treasures

Everyone says the Way is great and beyond comparison. Because it is great, it cannot be compared. If it were compared, it already would have seemed small.

I have three treasures to be maintained and cherished:

the first is love;

the second is frugality;

the third is not pushing oneself

Everyone says: "Nature is great, yet Nature is simple." It is great because it is simple. If it were not simple, long ago it would have come to little.

Nature sustains itself through three precious principles, which one does well to embrace and follow. These are gentleness, frugality and humility.

When one is gentle, he has no fear of retaliation.

In life I am great, but to the world I am a failure

In my grandeur, I am different from all the rest

And that is exactly therefore the reason I am great

If I would be like the rest, I would be just as unimportant and insignificant

I have three treasures I cherish:

The first is compassion

The second is austerity

The third is modesty

THE THREE JEWELS

They say that while this Tao of mine is great, yet it is inferior. This is the proof of its greatness. If it were like anything else, its smallness would have long been known.

I have three jewels of price whereto I cleave; gentleness, economy,

Many consider my teaching to be nonsense.

But the profound is a lot like nonsense.

If a teaching does not seem nonsensical, then it must be trivial.

I have three treasures to guard and preserve:

The first is compassion.

The second is self-restraint.

The third is not wanting to be ahead of others.

Compassion breeds

ahead of others.

From love comes courage;

from frugality comes generosity;

from not pushing oneself ahead of others comes leadership.

Now courage without love, generosity without frugality, and leadership by pushing oneself ahead of others are fatal.

For love wins all battles and is the strongest defense.

Heaven gives love to save and protect.

When one is frugal, he has no fear of retaliation. When one is humble, no one challenges his leadership.

When rudeness replaces gentleness, And extravagance replaces frugality, and pride replaces humility, The one is doomed.

Since a gentle attack arouses little antagonism, And a gentle defense provokes little anger, Nature predisposes to gentleness those most suited for survival.

am austere I can be unselfish

Because I am modest I can lead the way

But one who abandons his compassion and yet wants to be brave

One who renounces austerity and yet wants to be unselfish

One who stops being modest and still wants to be important

Won't make it far

One who fights with compassion, will conquer

Because he doesn't need to defend himself, he's invulnerable

and humility.

That gentleness maketh me courageous, that economy generous, that humility honoured. Men of today abandon gentleness for violence, economy for extravagance, humility for pride: this is death.

Gentleness bringeth victory in fight; and holdeth its ground with

fortitude.

Self-restraint breeds generosity.

Not wanting to be ahead of others breeds leadership.

These days, people want courage without compassion, generosity without self-restraint, and leadership without the willingness to be led.

This is death.

Compassion rules!

On the attack, it wins.

On the defense, it holds the fort.

.

The Power of Not Striving

The best soldier is not violent.

The best fighter is not angry.

The best winner is not contentious.

The

The best soldier does not attack. The superior fighter succeeds without violence.

The greatest conqueror wins without a struggle.

One who fights for peace is non-violent

A true fighter is unshakeable

A true victor does not argue

A true leader is the least

That's what people call "non-violent"

ASSIMILATING ONE'S SELF TO HEAVEN

He that is skilled in war maketh no fierce gestures; the most efficient

fighter bewareth of anger. He who conquereth refraineth from engaging in battle; he whom men

The best soldier does not rush into battle.

The best fighter does not display his anger.

The best conqueror does not take vengeance on his enemy.

The best

best employer is humble.

This is known as the power of not striving, as ability in human relations, and as being in accord with heaven.

The most successful manager leads without dictating.

This is called intelligent nonaggressiveness. This is called mastery of men. This is called matching the wisdom of the highest and oldest in Nature.

defensibility"

And that's how one gets the people on his side

That is called "living according to your nature"

That is the perfection of which the wise of old spoke

most willingly obey continueth silently with his

Work. So it is said: 'He is mighty who fighteth not; he ruleth who

uniteth with his subjects; he shineth whose will is that of Heaven.'

leader is the best follower.

This is known as the power [Te] of not contending.

This is known as true leadership.

This is known as following Heaven's lead.

.
The Kind Win
The strategists say,
"Do not be the
aggressor but the
defender.
Do not advance an
inch, but retreat a
foot instead."
This is movement
without moving,
stretching the arm
without showing it,
confronting enemies
with

Military maxims say:
"It is easier to defend
than to attack." "It is
better to back away a
foot than to assault to
gain an inch."
This means that the
best way to advance
is to retreat. He who
bares his flesh will
appear to have no
need for carrying
weapons. He who
does not flourish
weapons appears to
have nothing to
defend.

One who understands
that quarrels will
never solve anything,
Won't start them
anymore and prefers
to wait
He rather takes a step
back or retracts
That's what people
call winning by
losing
Showing strength
without impressing

THE USE OF THE
MYSTERIOUS
WAY
A great strategist
saith: 'I dare not take
the offensive. I prefer
the
defensive. I dare not
advance an inch; I
prefer to retreat a
foot.'
Place therefore the
army where there is
no army; prepare for
action where
there is no
engagement; strike
where there

There is a saying
among military
strategists:
"Instead of
advancing, I'll be
advanced upon;
it is better to retreat a
foot than to advance
an inch."
This is known as
advancing without
advancing,
getting ready without
showing

the idea there is no
enemy,
holding in the hand
no weapons.
No disaster is greater
than underestimating
the enemy.
Underestimating the
enemy will destroy
my treasures.
Thus when the battle
is joined,
it is the kind who will
win.

He who does not
prepare to defend
himself appears to
have no enemies.
No one will attack a
person unless he
appears to be an
enemy, For to attack
one who is not an
enemy is to lose a
friend.
Therefore, when
opposing enemies
meet for open battle,
he who runs away to
hide is the one who
wins.

Standing firm
without starting a
fight
Nothing is more
disastrous than
underestimating your
enemy
One who
underestimates his
enemy exposes
oneself to danger
Therefore he who's
driven by
compassion
Is always the winner
in a conflict

is no conflict;
advance
against the enemy
where the enemy is
not.
There is no error so
great as to engage in
battle without
sufficient
force. To do so is to
risk losing the
gentleness which is
beyond price.
Thus when the lines
actually engage, he
who regreteth the
necessity is
the victor.

your muscles,
capturing without
attacking,
being well-armed
without weapons.
There is nothing
worse than
underestimating your
enemy.
That leads to total
defeat.
Therefore, when
armies clash,
it is the side that does
not rejoice in
war-making that
wins.

.
My Ideas Are Easy
My ideas are easy to understand and easy to practice.
Yet no one understands them or practices them.
My ideas have a source; my actions have

The things I am saying are very easy to understand and very easy to practice. Yet no one in the world can comprehend them fully nor practice them perfectly.
The things I am saying did not originate with me but have their source in Nature.

My words are easy to comprehend
And easy to bring to practice
Yet no one in the world wants to surrender to them
And no one feels capable of living according to them
My words have an origin, my way of living a

THE DIFFICULTY OF RIGHT APPREHENSION
My words are easy to understand and to perform; but is there anyone in the world who can understand them and perform them?
My words derive from a creative and universal Principle, in

My teachings are very easy to understand
and even easier to put into practice.
And yet, no one understands or practices them.
My teachings are derived from an ancient system of principles.

a master.
Because people do not understand this, they do not know me.
Since few know me, I am very precious.
Therefore the wise wear coarse clothes and keep the jewel inside.

It is because men do not understand this source that they do not understand me. Since those who understand me are few, they are, for that reason, all the more worthy of emulation.
Therefore the intelligent man presents a poor exterior, yet carries Nature's riches embedded in his core.

principle
But because the people do not dare to see this
They are not able to understand me
There are only a few who understand me and to them I am most precious
One who is wise therefore acts unnoticed, but remains oneself

accord with the One Law. Men, not knowing these, understand me not.
Few are they that understand me; therefore am I the more to be valued.
The Wise Man weareth sack-cloth, but guardeth his jewel in his bosom.

People who do not realize this do not really know me.
Few know me, but that is my value.
Therefore, the Tao–Master wears rough clothing, but has a jewel for a heart.

.

A Disease

To know that you do not know is the best.

To think you know when you do not is a disease.

Recognizing this disease as

To know how little one knows is to have genuine knowledge.

Not to know how little one knows is to be deluded.

Only he who knows when he is deluded can free himself from such delusion.

Realizing you can't know anything, is wise

One who does not understand he can't know anything, is insane

One who realizes his insanity,

Is able

THE DISTEMPER OF KNOWLEDGE

To know, yet to know nothing, is the highest; not to know, yet to pretend to knowledge, is a distemper.

Painful is this distemper; therefore we shun it.

To know that you do not know is strength.

Not knowing that you do not know is a sickness.

The cure

a disease is to be free of it.

The wise are free of disease,

because they recognize the disease as a disease.

Therefore they are free of disease.

The intelligent man is not deluded, because he knows and accepts his ignorance, and accepts his ignorance as ignorance, and thereby has genuine knowledge.

to get rid of it

One who is wise is not insane anymore,

Because he has disposed of his insanity

Therefore he has a clear view

The wise man hath it not. Knowing it to be bound up with Sorrow, he putteth it away from him.

begins with the recognition of the sickness.

The Tao—Master is not sick, but he is sick of sickness.

Thus, he is well.

.
Do Not Suppress
When people lack a sense of awe,
then something awful will happen.
Do not constrict people's living space.
Do not suppress their livelihoods.
If you do not harass

Do not be irritated when people do not recognize your importance; For if you are really important, sooner or later circumstances will force them to recognize it.
Do not treat them contemptuously nor despise them; For only when you do not despise them will they not despise you.

When people have forgotten what to be afraid of,
They will live in vague fear
Why do they come to terms with this miserable way of living?
Why don't they see the beauty of life?
Why are they

CONCERNING LOVE OF SELF
When men fear not that which is to be feared, that which they fear cometh upon them.
Let them not live, without thought, the superficial life.
Let them not weary of the

When the people do not fear your power, then your power has become truly great.
Do not intrude into their homes.
Do not interfere with their work.
If you do not oppress them,

them, they will not harass you.
Therefore the wise know themselves but do not display themselves.
They love themselves but do not exalt themselves.
They let go of one and accept the other.

Although the intelligent man knows his own importance, He does not require that others recognize it; and he esteems himself for what he is, But does not insist that others esteem him. He does not seek to be esteemed by others because he recognizes his self-esteem as sufficient.

so scared of escaping their rut?
One who is wise understands this, and won't flaunt it
He enjoys it but doesn't consider it as his own merit
He abandons his old way of living and embraces true life

Spring of Life!
By avoiding the superficial life, this weariness cometh not upon them.
These things the wise man knoweth, not showeth: he loveth himself,
without isolating his value. He accepteth the former and rejecteth the latter.

then they will not become sick of you.
Thus, the Tao–Master knows himself, but does not show himself.
He loves himself, but is not arrogant.
Therefore, he lets go of that and chooses this.

The Way of Heaven
Those brave in
killing will be killed.
Those brave in not
killing will live.
Of these two, one is
good, and one is
harmful.
Some are not favored
by heaven. Who
knows why?
Even the wise
consider it a difficult
question.
The Way of

He whose courage
expresses itself as
defiance is often put
to death. He whose
courage manifests
itself as patience to
endure insult
continues to live.
Of these two kinds of
courage, the one is
beneficial, the other
harmful. Many
people are puzzled as
to why, of two
courageous men, one
is harmed and one
benefited.

Having guts and
being reckless will
lead to death
Having guts and
being cautious saves
life
The first is useless;
the other useful
Only one who is wise
understands the
course of things
Therefore he won't
intervene
It is easy to infringe

ESTABLISHING
THE LAW OF
FREEDOM
One man, daring, is
executed; another,
not daring, liveth. It
would seem
as if the one course
were profitable and
the other detrimental.
Yet when
Heaven smiteth a
man, who shall
assign the cause
thereof? Therefore the
sage is diffident.
The Tao of

A man of daring
courage will kill or
be killed.
A man of cautious
courage seeks to save
lives.
Each of these may be
either beneficial or
harmful.
Heaven hates what it
hates.
Who knows why?
Even the Tao-Master
can't figure

heaven does not
strive; yet it wins
easily.
It does not speak; yet
it gets a good
response.
It does not demand;
yet all needs are met.
It is not anxious; yet
it plans well.
The net of heaven is
vast;
its meshes are wide,
but nothing slips
through.

But the intelligent
man finds no
difficulty with this
question.
Nature itself has the
patience to endure
insult, yet always
wins in the end. It
does not explain;
nevertheless all
understand. It does
not command; but all
eventually obey. It
does not hurry; yet
everything is
accomplished.
Nature's web is so
finely woven - wide
enough to catch the
biggest, fine enough
to catch the smallest -
that not a single thing
escapes.

upon the eternal laws
of nature
But they always
triumph
They don't speak, yet
they do answer
They don't yell, yet
everybody hears
them
Like a net, the
original order
protects the Universe
Though its meshes
seem wide, nothing
can come through

Heaven contendeth
not, yet it
overcometh; it is
silent, yet
its need is answered;
it summoneth none,
but all men come to it
of their
free will. Its method
is quietness, yet its
will is efficient.
Large
are the meshes of
Heaven's Net; wide
open, yet letting none
escape.

it out.
The Tao does not
contend, but it
prevails.
It does not speak, but
it answers.
It is not called, but it
responds.
It has no purpose, but
it achieves all of its
aims.
Heaven's net is wide;
nothing slips
through.

.
Death
People are not afraid
to die.
So why threaten
them with death?
If people were afraid
of death,
and lawbreakers
could be caught and
put to death,
who would dare to do
so?
There is

It is futile to threaten
people with death. If
they are not afraid to
die, they cannot be
frightened by the
death penalty; and if
they are afraid to die,
why should we kill
them?
Only Nature knows
the proper time for a
man to die.

When people no
longer fear death
How can one
threaten them with
it?
But if people are
afraid of death and
other people threaten
to kill them
When they infringe
upon the law
Well, who is still
going to break the
law?
But there is

A RESTRAINT OF
MISUNDERSTANDING
The people have no
fear of death; why
then seek to awe
them by the threat
of death? If the
people feared death
and I could put to
death evil-doers,
who would dare

If people do not fear
death,
then you cannot
threaten them with it.
If they are afraid of
death,
we could make death
the penalty for
breaking the law.
But do we dare

the Lord of Death
who executes.
Trying to do his job
is like trying to cut
wood for the Master
Carpenter.
Those who try to cut
wood for the Master
Carpenter
rarely escape injuring
their own hands.

To kill is to interrupt
Nature's design for
dying, Like a
blundering
apprentice judging
himself to be wiser
than his master.
Whenever an
apprentice thinks he
is smarter than his
master, he is very
likely to hurt himself.

only One who
commands life and
death
Since people started
to decide about life
and death themselves
They have actually
taken a place on that
One's chair
Then they behave
like sorcerer's
apprentices
Who assault the
works of their
master,
With disastrous
consequences for
themselves

to offend?
There is one
appointed to inflict
death. He who would
usurp that position
resembleth a hewer
of wood doing the
work of a carpenter.
Such an one,
presumptuous, will
be sure to cut his own
hands.

to do so?
Consider the role of
the official
executioner:
Are you ready to play
that role?
When amateurs try to
play the master
carpenter,
they usually cut and
bruise themselves in
the process.

Valuing Life
People are hungry,
because rulers eat too
much tax-grain.
That is why people
are starving.
People are hard to
govern,
because rulers
interfere too much.
That is why they are
hard to govern.

Those who make
their living by
collecting taxes cause
the people to starve;
when the people
starve, the tax
collectors, having no
one to tax, starve
also.
Those who govern
people make them
discontented with
being controlled; and
therefore cause them
to be uncontrollable.
Those who are so
eager to make a
better living that they
risk death in doing so
are the very ones
most likely to die.

People starve
Because the wealthy
enrich themselves off
other people's backs
That's why people
starve
People cannot be
kept under control
Because their leaders
don't know what
they're doing
That's why people
cannot be

THE INJURY OF
GREED
In such a state of
insecurity it is

When taxes are too
high, people starve.
When the
government is too
intrusive,
it makes life no
longer worth living,
and
the

People do not care
about death,
because rulers
demand too much of
life.
That is why they do
not care about death.
Only those who do
not interfere with
living
are best at valuing
life.

Only the
self-sufficient person
who depends upon
and endangers no one
else in order to get
his living is most
sure to live.

kept under control
People want to die
Because they don't
want to live this way
Therefore people
want to die
Only the one who is
not afraid to live,
Is not afraid of dying

better to ignore the
question of living
than to set store by it.

people lose their love
of life and their fear
of death.
To promote the value
of life, do not
interfere with it.

.

Life Is Tender

When people are born, they are tender and supple.

At death they are stiff and hard.

All things, like plants and trees, are tender and pliant while alive.

At death they are dried and withered.

At birth a man is soft and weak - yet capable of living the whole life ahead of him. At death he is hard and tough - yet unable to live for even a minute longer.

All things, whether plants or animals, while living, are soft and weak, But, when dead, are hard and tough.

When a human being is born, it's supple and weak

When it dies it's stiff and strong

Everything that's alive (take a look at grass and trees for example)

Is supple and flexible

And when they die they are shriveled and parched

Therefore

A WARNING AGAINST RIGIDITY

At the birth of man, he is elastic and weak; at his death, rigid and unyielding. This is the common law; trees also, in their youth, are tender and supple; in their decay, hard and dry.

So then rigidity

People are born soft and flexible;

when they are dead, they are hard and stiff.

Living plants are tender and pliant;

when they are dead, they are brittle and dried out.

Therefore, whatever is hard and stiff is a

Therefore the stiff and hard are companions of death.

The tender and supple are companions of life.

Thus strong arms do not win.

A stiff tree will break.

The hard and strong will fall.

The tender and supple will rise.

Thus hardness and toughness are allied with death, While softness and weakness are interrelated with life.

This is the reason why the tougher fighters are more likely to be killed, and the harder trees more likely to be cut down.

Therefore it is better to be soft and weak than to be hard and tough.

hardness and inflexibility are companions of death

And suppleness and softness, companions of life

That's why a rigid troublemaker will never win

And an inflexible tree is doomed to death

Inflexibility and power won't get you very far

Suppleness and softness get you everywhere

and hardness are the stigmata of death; elasticity and adaptability, of life.

He then who putteth forth strength is not victorious; even as a strong tree filleth the embrace.

Thus the hard and rigid have the inferior place, the soft and elastic the superior.

sign of death.

Whatever is soft and flexible is a sign of life.

An army without flexibility never wins.

An unbending tree is easily brought down by the wind.

The hard and stiff fall.

The soft and flexible rise.

Taking and Giving
The Way of heaven
is like bending a
bow.
The high is lowered;
the low is raised.
The excessive is
reduced; the deficient
is increased.
The Way of heaven
takes from those who
have too much
and gives to those
who do not have
enough.
The human way is
different.
It takes from

Nature's way is like
the bending of a bow:
The top which is high
is lowered while the
bottom which is low
is raised, And the
width which is
narrow is widened
while the length
which is long is
shortened.
Nature's way is to
take from those that
have too much and
give to those that
have too little.
Man's way, on the
contrary, is to take
away from those who
have too little to give
more to those who
already have too
much.

The natural order is
like stretching a bow
The low bow gets
pushed up high
And the high tendon
pulled downwards
Where there is too
much, it takes away
Where there is not
enough, it fills
Nature strives for
harmony all the time
Decreases where
there is too much
And increases where
there is too little
But how opposite are
the

THE WAY OF
HEAVEN
The Tao of Heaven is
likened to the
bending of a bow,
whereby the high
part is brought down,
and the low part
raised up. The
extreme is
diminished, and the
middle increased.
This is the Way of
Heaven, to remove
excess, and to
supplement
insufficiency.

The Tao is like the
bending of a bow.
The top is bent
downward; the
bottom is bent up.
If the cord is too
long, it is shortened;
if it is too short, it is
lengthened.
The policy of the Tao
is to take from those
who have too much
and give to those
who have too little.
But that is not the

those who do not
have enough
and gives to those
who have too much.
Who has more than
enough to give to the
world?
Only the person of
the Way.
Therefore the wise
act but do not rely on
their own ability.
They accomplish the
task but claim no
credit.
They have no desire
to seem superior.

What kind of man is
able to take away
from his own more
than enough and give
to others who have
less than enough?
Only he who
embodies Nature's
way within himself.
Such a man gives his
gift without desiring
a reward, achieves
benefit for others
without expecting
approbation, And is
generous without
calling attention to
his generosity.

people in their
behaviour
The poor get poorer
while the rich tend to
get richer
But one who is wise
realizes that
possession is
burglary to
community
Therefore he
disposes himself of
that which belongs to
the community
So only one who is
wise is detached
He does what others
ask him to, but
nothing for himself
Without taking credit
for it

Not so is the way of
man, who taketh
away from him that
hath not to give to
him that hath already
excess.
Who can employ his
own excess to the
weal of all under
Heaven? Only he
that possesseth the
Tao.
So the Wise Man
acteth without lust of
result; achieveth and
boasteth
not; he willeth not to
proclaim his
greatness.

human practice.
We take from those
who have too little
and give to those
who have too much.
Who is it that has
more than enough
and gives his surplus
to those in need?
Only the follower of
the Tao.
The follower of the
Tao acts without
hope of gain,
accomplishes but
takes no credit,
does not wish to lord
it over others.

.

The Soft and Weak

Nothing in the world is softer and weaker than water.

Yet nothing is better at attacking the hard and strong.

There is no substitute for it.

The weak overcomes the strong; the soft overcomes the hard.

Everyone knows this, but

Nothing is weaker than water; Yet, for attacking what is hard and tough, Nothing surpasses it, nothing equals it.

The principle, that what is weak overcomes what is strong, And what is yielding conquers what is resistant, Is known to everybody. Yet few men utilize it profitably in practice.

But —

Nothing in life is so soft and compliant as water

Nothing is stronger in breaking what is hard and strong

Nothing can exceed it in doing this

Weak overcomes strong

Soft overcomes hard

Nobody knows this

And no one

A CREED

Nothing in the world is more elastic and yielding than water; yet it is preeminent to dissolve things rigid and resistant; there is nothing which can match it.

All men know that the soft overcometh the hard, and the weak conquereth the strong; but none

Water is soft and yielding, but nothing can more effectively dissolve the hard and inflexible.

Weak defeats strong.

Soft defeats hard.

This is well-known, but not easy to put into practice.

Therefore, the Tao-Master says:

He

no one puts it into practice.

Therefore the wise say,

"Those who bear the humiliation of the people are able to minister to them.

Those who take upon themselves the sins of the society are able to lead the world."

Words of truth seem paradoxical.

the intelligent man knows that: He who willingly takes the blame for disgrace to his community is considered a responsible person, And he who submissively accepts responsibility for the evils in his community naturally will be given enough authority for dealing with them.

These principles, no matter how paradoxical, are sound.

practices it

Therefore the sage says:

One who is the least in the world, will be the greatest in life

One who carries the sorrow of the world, is the greatest among mankind

It sounds odd, but it's true

are able to use this law in action.

A Wise Man hath said: 'He that taketh on the burden of the state is a demigod worthy of sacrificial worship; and the true King of a people is he that undertaketh the weight of their sorrows.'

Truth appeareth paradox.

who takes upon himself the dirt of the nation

becomes the master of its sacred soil;

he who takes upon himself the evils of the land

becomes a true king under Heaven.

Straight words seem crooked.

.
Stay with the Good
Compromising with
great hatred surely
leaves some hatred.
How can this be
considered good?
Therefore the wise
keep their part of an
agreement
and

Make agreements
and then quarrelling
when they are broken
is never advisable.
For even when a
quarrel is patched up,
some animosity will
remain. How can this
be considered good?
Therefore the
intelligent man
continues to carry out
his side of a bargain
Even though he

When people make
peace after violent
hostility
Then it's an armed
peace
How can it be right?
One who is wise only
takes a look at his
own share in the
conflict
And never blames his
opponent

TRUTH IN
COVENANT
When enemies are
reconciled, there is
always an aftermath
of illwill.
How can this be
useful?
Therefore, the Wise
Man, while he
keepeth his part of
the record of a
transaction, doth not
insist on its prompt
execution.

Great resentment,
even when appeased,
does not go away.
How can this be
good?
Therefore, the
Tao–Master keeps
his promises,
but he does not look
into whether others
are keeping

do not blame the
other party.
The good fulfill their
obligations;
the bad exact
obligations from
others.
The Way of heaven
is impartial.
It always stays with
the good.

does not demand of
others that they fulfill
their promises
The righteous insist
on keeping
agreements to the
letter, And the
indiscreet foolishly
neglect or break their
agreements;
But Nature neither
keeps nor breaks
contracts (because it
makes none). And its
ways are good for
men.

So one who is fair
only faces his own
part
While one who is not
daring enough to
look at oneself,
blames the other
The road to
self-knowledge
knows no partiality
But it does benefit
the sincere

He who hath the
Teh considereth the
situation from all
sides, while he who
hath it not
seeketh only to
benefit himself.
In the Tao of
Heaven, there is no
distinction of persons
in its love; but
it is for the True Man
to claim it.

theirs.
The man of virtue
(Te) monitors
himself;
The man without
virtue monitors
others.
The Tao of Heaven
plays no favorites,
but it is always
manifest in the good
man.

. Home Is Comfortable In a small country with few people machines that can work ten or a hundred times faster are not needed. People who care about death do not travel far. Even if there are ships and carriages, no one takes them. Even if there are armor	The ideal state is a small intimate community Where all the necessities of life are present in abundance. There everyone is satisfied to live and die without looking around for greener pastures. Even if they have cars or boats, they do not use them for travelling abroad. Even if they have police and fortifications, these are never put to use.	May mankind live in freedom, equality and brotherhood again, So that there will be no need for leaders and superiors Then people won't fear death any longer And won't try to escape death May it be that people don't feel the need anymore, To move themselves about in vehicles And that they will have nothing to defend anymore May humankind abandon their instruments and machines,	ISOLATION In a little kingdom of few people it should be the order that though there were men able to do the work of ten men or five score, they should not be employed. Though the people regarded death as sorrowful, yet they should not wish to go elsewhere. They should have boats and wagons, yet no necessity to travel;	Imagine a small country with a small population. They have lots of technology, but they use none of it. They take the prospect of death seriously and thus do not travel far from home. They have boats and carriages, but no one takes them out. They have weapons and armor, but no one takes them out of the armory. Instead of writing, they have gone back
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and weapons, no one displays them. People return to knotted rope for records. Food is tasty; clothes are beautiful; home is comfortable; customs are delightful. Though neighboring communities see each other and hear each other's cocks crowing and dogs barking, they may grow old and die without going there.	The people are satisfied with their food, Contented with their clothing, Comfortable in their dwellings, And happy with their customs. Even though neighbouring communities are within sight, And the crowing of the neighbour's cocks and barking of the neighbour's dogs are within hearing, They grow old and die without ever troubling themselves to go outside of their own communities.	And enjoy the seeds of the fruit-bearing plants Those were meant as our food May they feel shamelessly proud of their natural beauty again May they stop locking themselves away in cities and houses, And start enjoying creation And if some fools still lock themselves away in nations, Civilizations, cities and houses May the wise men keep themselves far from this,	corslets and weapons, yet no occasion to fight. For communication they should use knotted cords. They should deem their food sweet, their clothes beautiful, their houses homes, their customs delightful. There should be another state within view, so that its fowls and dogs should be heard; yet to old age, even to death, the people should hold no traffic with it.	system of cord-knotting. They enjoy their plain but good food, their simple but fine clothing, their humble but secure homes. They are happy with their way of life. The next country is so close that the crowing of the cocks and the barking of the dogs over there can be easily heard over here; and yet the people over here grow old and die
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True Words
True words are not beautiful.
Beautiful words are not truthful.
The good do not argue.
Those who argue are not good.
Those who know are not scholarly.
The scholarly do not know.

He who is genuine is not artificial; He who is artificial is not genuine.
He who is intelligent is not quarrelsome; He who is quarrelsome is not intelligent.
He who is wise is not pretentious; He who is pretentious is not wise.
Therefore the intelligent man does not struggle to achieve for himself.

True words are not pretty
Pretty words are not true
Wise men do not talk about the Unspeakable
One who talks about the Unspeakable is not wise
Wise men are not learned
And learned ones aren't wise
A wise man

THE SHEWING-FORTH OF SIMPLICITY
True speech is not elegant; elaborate speech is not truth. Those who know do not argue; the argumentative are without knowledge. Those who have assimilated are not learned; those who are gross with learning have not assimilated.
The Wise Man doth not hoard.

True words aren't pretty; pretty words aren't true.
The good do not contend; those who contend aren't good.
The wise are not learned; the learned are not wise.
The Tao—Master is not

The wise do not hoard.
The more they give to others, the more they have.
The Way of heaven sharpens but does no harm.
The Way of the wise accomplishes without striving.
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The more useful he is to others, the more his needs will be cared for by those repeatedly benefited by his yielding.
Nature's way is to produce good without evil. The intelligent man's way is to accept and follow Nature rather than to oppose Nature.

doesn't gather possessions
He gives what he has
And therefore he is worthy of living
He shares his wisdom with others
His wisdom is never-ending
Living according to nature never harms
The life of a wise man is unselfish and peaceful

The more he giveth, the more he hath; the more he watereth, the more is he watered himself.
The Tao of Heaven is like an Arrow, yet it woundeth not; and the Wise
Man, in all his Works, maketh no contention.

greedy.
The more he does for others, the more he has.
The more he gives to others, the richer he becomes.
The Tao sharpens without cutting.
The Tao—Master acts with non-ado.
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